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CURRENT AFFAIRS JULY 2026

Important One-Liners – Category Wise

For UPSC • State PCS • Banking • SSC • Railway • All Govt Exams

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▶ BANKING & FINANCE

1. PayGlocal – Launched Google Pay Card Payments for Indian merchants enabling global international transactions across 86+ countries and 60+ currencies

2. Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank – Achieved RBI Tier-III UCB status after deposits crossed ₹2,000 crore; reported zero Net NPA and ₹16.18 crore net profit

3. UPI in Greece – Launched through the Eurobank-NIPL partnership; NIPL is the international arm of NPCI

4. Visa Payment Passkey – IDFC FIRST Bank became India's first issuer; enables OTP-less payment authentication using FIDO-based public-key cryptography

5. NPCI – HSBC India-JP Morgan tie-up – For real-time forex conversion and settlement for overseas UPI payments; UPI now accepted in 9 countries

6. RBI penalty on Bank of Baroda – ₹63.6 lakh for violating Fair Practices Code and KYC norms; GIC Housing Finance fined ₹3.1 lakh

7. Paytm Europe – Received Payment Institution Licence from CSSF (Luxembourg's financial regulator); invested additional €9 million in European operations

8. RBI Financial Inclusion Index – Rose to 70 in FY26 from 67 in FY25, driven by higher usage; index launched in 2021, based on Access, Usage, Quality

9. NSE Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs) – Physical gold in dematerialised form; backed by SEBI-accredited vaults; traded like demat securities

10. Glomo – India's first non-bank acquirer with Visa Principal Membership; operates at GIFT IFSC, Gandhinagar, Gujarat

11. Federal Bank – Received inaugural BBB-/Stable rating from S&P; BBB- is lowest investment-grade long-term credit rating

12. Bank of Maharashtra FinSpark 2026 – National-level cybersecurity hackathon on banking cyber risks; finale at Pune with ₹10 lakh+ prize

13. RBI polymer banknotes – Government approved 1 billion ₹10 & ₹20 polymer notes for field trials; first country with polymer notes was Australia (1988)

14. SBI perpetual bonds 2026 – ₹5,000 crore Additional Tier-I (AT-1) Basel III-compliant bonds; first bank to issue perpetual bonds in 2026

15. Paytm Payments Bank liquidator – Delhi High Court appointed Girikumar M. Nair (former SBI Chief GM) under Banking Regulation Act, 1949

16. Edelweiss MF – To launch India's first REIT-oriented Index Fund; tracks Nifty REITs & Realty Total Return Index (MD & CEO: Radhika Gupta)

17. Delhivery Financial Services – Received RBI nod for NBFC registration as Type-II NBFC-ND; Delhivery handled 1 billion express parcel shipments in FY26

18. EnKash UPI Meal Card – India's first UPI-enabled Meal Card; first provider to enable UPI payments from meal benefit balance

19. DBS Bank – First Southeast Asian bank named 'World Best Corporate Bank' at 2026 Global Finance Global Bank Awards; operates in 19 markets

20. SBI Card + Google Pay – Launched Google Pay Flex SBI Card on RuPay & Visa networks with ₹18,000 annual rewards

▶ ECONOMY

21. NIIF additional investment – Union Cabinet approved ₹30,000 crore more; total NIIF commitment now ₹60,000 crore; NIIF established in 2015

22. India GDP FY27 (IMF) – Projected at 6.4%; driven by private consumption and services; Global growth projected at 3.0% in 2026

23. ADB India GDP FY27 – Forecast cut to 6.6% citing West Asia tensions; FY28 forecast retained at 7.3%; ADB established in 1966

24. ADB Chennai water project – $230 million loan; Chennai to become India's first city with ring-main water supply system; 4.5 million residents to benefit

25. India outward FDI June 2026 – Fell 47.9% YoY to $3 billion; FY26 total outward FDI commitments stood at $48.6 billion

26. CBDT Cost Inflation Index FY27 – Raised to 384 (previous year: 376); used to calculate long-term capital gains

27. NSE Natural Gas Futures – India's first domestic benchmark-based natural gas futures (symbol: NATGASIND); based on IGX Gujarat (Dahej) Hub price; cash-settled

28. World Bank Rooftop Solar – Approved $890 million for PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana; targets 1 crore households; creates 1.7 million jobs

29. India Q1 FY27 Exports – Rose 11.4% to USD 232.7 billion; merchandise exports up 15.9%; trade deficit widened to USD 37.4 billion

30. Windfall tax revision – Government raised diesel export duty to ₹15.5/litre, ATF to ₹14.5/litre; reduced petrol levy to ₹2.5/litre

31. ADB $850 million loan – For PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana; targets 10 million households; aims to add 30 GW rooftop solar by FY2027

32. ICRA securitisation volumes – Rose 20% YoY to ₹61,000 crore in Q1 FY27; NBFC issuances up 27% YoY

33. FDI rules for e – commerce – India relaxed FDI rules allowing foreign-funded e-commerce companies to operate inventory-based model for export; regulated under FEMA, 1999

34. L&T Kuwait Oil Company – Won major EPC contract worth up to ₹10,000 crore to build 6 crude oil storage tanks; executed by L&T Energy Hydrocarbon Onshore

35. Powergrid JBIC green loan – Secured 80 billion yen for Khavda-Nagpur HVDC project; JBIC = Japan Bank for International Cooperation

▶ NATIONAL

36. QDENGA dengue vaccine – India's first dengue vaccine approved by CDSCO; developed by Takeda (Japan); protects against all 4 dengue serotypes

37. Shabdalok Language Museum – India's first immersive language museum inaugurated by Amit Shah in Kolkata; showcases 22 official languages using digital technology

38. Geothermal wells Ladakh – India's first two geothermal wells commissioned at Puga Valley by ONGC Energy Centre; drilled to 1,000 metres depth

39. NITI Aayog Bioeconomy Roadmap 2035 – Targets USD 691 billion bioeconomy; proposes ₹50,000 crore BioEconomy Growth Fund; 30 million+ jobs

40. NTA Task Force – PM Modi announced task force headed by Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani; to recommend structural reforms to NTA examination system

41. Kamarajar Port 18 – metre draft – Tamil Nadu port became India's 2nd major port with 18-metre draft; can handle Capesize vessels up to 1,70,000 DWT

42. Mizoram NHM as Designated Repository – 21st Designated Repository under Biological Diversity Act, 2002; located in Indo-Burma Biodiversity Hotspot

43. DAANVEER initiative – Ministry of Panchayati Raj; strengthens digital infrastructure in 2.5 lakh Gram Panchayats; available through Meri Panchayat App

44. NIPU – 2026 – National Investment Policy for Urea-2026; encourages new gas-based urea units; introduces RoE band of 12%-16%; India has 33 urea manufacturing units

45. NIDAR 2.0 – MeitY launched under SwaYaan initiative; develops drones using Indian-made chips; prize pool ₹65 lakh+

46. India UNSC campaign – Campaign for non-permanent seat for 2028-29 term; launched by S. Jaishankar; will compete with Tajikistan in Asia-Pacific Group

47. Sarnath UNESCO World Heritage Site – India's 45th; announced at 48th Session of World Heritage Committee in Busan, South Korea; 4th site from UP

48. MECON Miniratna Category – I – Achieved after net worth of ₹535.42 crore; MECON HQ: Ranchi, Jharkhand

49. Global Biofuel Alliance – Selected 15 researchers under GBCF from 32 countries; each fellow gets $15,000 grant; GBA launched at G20 Summit 2023 (New Delhi)

50. India's first high – altitude medicine centre – ICMR to set up at Keylong, Himachal Pradesh; will collaborate with AFMS and DRDO

51. Vizhinjam Port Customs nod – Received Exim operations approval from 18 August 2026 by CBIC; handled 2 million TEUs within 18 months; developed under PPP

▶ INTERNATIONAL

52. France social media ban – First European country to ban social media for children below 15; mandatory age verification by January 2027

53. Pakistan SAF Games 2027 – Will host 2027 South Asian Federation Games; first SAF Games held in Kathmandu, Nepal in 1984

54. Standard Chartered Swift scheme – First bank in India to process remittance under Swift's new retail payments scheme; Australia-India payment in 37 seconds

55. CAC49 Codex standards – Adopted 7 Codex standards developed under India's leadership; approved Codex Standard for Cashew Kernels; Indian delegation led by Rajit Punhani, FSSAI CEO

56. Saudi Arabia maritime coalition – 14 nations formed Multinational Maritime Defence Coalition; protects Bab el-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea & Gulf of Aden

57. 36th NATO Summit 2026 – Held in Ankara, Turkey; Turkey hosted NATO Summit second time (first in Istanbul, 2004); Secretary General: Mark Rutte

▶ SPORTS

58. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi – India's youngest international cricketer at 15 years 99 days; broke Sachin Tendulkar's record; debut cap from Tilak Varma

59. Australia Women's T20 World Cup – Won record 7th title; defeated England by 7 wickets at Lord's London; Sophie Molineux (captain), Beth Mooney (Player of Match & Tournament)

60. Wimbledon 2026 – Men's: Jannik Sinner (Italy); Women's: Linda Noskova (Czech Republic) – her first Grand Slam; both received record £3.6 million prize

61. FIFA World Cup 2026 – Spain beat Argentina 1-0 in extra time; Ferran Torres scored winning goal; final at MetLife Stadium, New Jersey; Spain's 2nd World Cup title

62. Mirabai Chanu CWG 2026 – India's first gold at Glasgow Commonwealth Games; 190 kg lift (CWG record) in women's 48 kg; 3-time consecutive CWG gold medallist

63. PV Sindhu Japan Open – First Indian to win Japan Open (BWF Super 750); defeated Akane Yamaguchi; ended nearly two-year title drought

64. Aswath S. – India's 98th Chess Grandmaster; achieved at Pune International Round-Robin Chess Tournament

65. Leander Paes – Appointed Player Ambassador of Asian Tennis Federation; has 18 Grand Slam titles; inducted into International Tennis Hall of Fame in 2024

66. George Russell – Won 2026 Austrian Grand Prix (Mercedes); 7th F1 career victory; race held at Red Bull Ring, Spielberg

67. Charles Leclerc – Won F1 British Grand Prix at Silverstone; Ferrari's 250th Grand Prix victory; Leclerc's 9th F1 win

68. Khelo India Youth Games – Telangana to host 8th edition in 2026; launched in 2018 to promote grassroots sports

69. ICC Hall of Fame – Sourav Ganguly, Kevin Pietersen & Anjum Chopra inducted; total members: 125; ICC HoF launched in 2009

70. India IChO 2026 – 4 gold medals at 58th International Chemistry Olympiad in Tashkent, Uzbekistan; joint first with China, Vietnam & Russia

71. India IPhO 2026 – 5 gold medals at 56th International Physics Olympiad in Bucaramanga, Colombia; joint first

72. India Biology Olympiad 2026 – 1 gold (Bhavyaa Gunwal) & 3 silver at IBO 2026 in Vilnius, Lithuania

73. Ajinkya Rahane – Retired from international cricket; played 85 Tests, 90 ODIs, 20 T20Is; captained India's 2020-21 Border-Gavaskar Trophy win in Australia

74. BWF World Championships 2026 – Mascot 'Peacko' (inspired by Indian Peafowl); New Delhi, 17-23 August 2026

75. Dilip Gavit – Gold in Men's 100m T47 at CWG 2026 (Commonwealth Games record); India achieved historic 1-2 finish; T47 = upper limb impairment category

76. Esha Singh – ISSF World Cup gold in women's 25m Pistol (Hangzhou, China); Manu Bhaker won bronze in same event

▶ APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

77. Rajiv Kumar – Named part-time non-executive Chairman of HDFC Bank for 3 years (subject to RBI approval); former Finance Secretary & CEC; succeeds Keki M. Mistry

78. Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit – Took over as Vice Chief of the Air Staff (IAF) on 1 July 2026; 2nd-highest ranking IAF officer; participated in Operation Sindoor

79. Vikram Misri – Foreign Secretary; received one-year extension till July 2027; India's Ambassador to China, Spain & Myanmar; appointed in June 2024

80. Anurag Jain – Appointed CEO of NITI Aayog for 2 years; 1989-batch IAS (MP cadre); former Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh

81. Andy Burnham – New Prime Minister of UK; 59th PM; succeeded Keir Starmer; invited by King Charles III

82. Viswanathan Anand – Interim President of FIDE; succeeds Arkady Dvorkovich (placed under EU sanctions); FIDE est. 1924, HQ Lausanne

83. Serhii Koretskyi – New Prime Minister of Ukraine; former CEO of Naftogaz; Parliament approved with 289 votes

84. Ashiss Kumar Dash – CEO-Designate of Infosys; will take charge from 1 April 2027; succeeds Salil Parekh

85. Dharmendra Pradhan – Resigned as Union Education Minister over NEET-UG 2026 paper leak; Pralhad Joshi given additional charge

86. Dilip Asbe (NPCI CEO) – Joined SWIFT's Global Supervisory Board; reflects global success of UPI and India's digital payments

87. Girikumar M. Nair – Appointed liquidator of Paytm Payments Bank by Delhi HC; former SBI Chief GM; liquidation under Banking Regulation Act, 1949

88. Mahesh Muralidhar Pai – RBI approved as MD & CEO of South Indian Bank for 3-year term from 1 October 2026

89. Mindaugas Sinkevicius – New Prime Minister of Lithuania; pledged defence spending above 5% of GDP; Capital: Vilnius | Currency: Euro

90. Harjit Singh Grewal – Assumed charge as Chairman, National Commission for Minorities (NCM); NCM established in 1992

91. Rear Admiral C. Raghuram – New CMD of Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL); HSL HQ: Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

92. Shailesh Jejurikar – Appointed Chairman, President & CEO of Procter & Gamble (P&G) effective 1 August 2026; P&G founded 1837

93. Keiko Fujimori – Won Peru's presidential election; daughter of former President Alberto Fujimori; Capital Lima | Currency Peruvian Sol

▶ AWARDS & HONOURS

94. Guardian of the Blue Horizon – PM Narendra Modi received this first-ever Presidential Distinction from Seychelles (President Dr. Patrick Herminie); for Blue Economy & climate action

95. Bintang Adipurna – Indonesia's highest civilian honour; PM Modi received from President Prabowo Subianto for strengthening India-Indonesia ties

96. ICMR – MINDS Gold e-Governance Award – Won Gold at National Awards for e-Governance 2026; under AI & New Age Technologies; for mental health screening

97. USISPF Leadership Award 2026 – Sunil Bharti Mittal; honoured for transforming India's telecom sector and strengthening India-US economic ties

98. 60th Jnanpith Award – R. Vairamuthu (Tamil poet & lyricist); 3rd Tamil writer to receive it; carries ₹11 lakh; Jnanpith Award inst. 1961

99. 72nd National Film Awards – Best Feature Film: Article 370; Best Actress: Yami Gautam; Best Actor: Mammootty & Kartik Aaryan (shared); Best Debut Director: Randeep Hooda (Swatantrya Veer Savarkar)

100. Lokmanya Tilak Award – NSA Ajit Doval selected; presented on 1 August (death anniversary of Bal Gangadhar Tilak); Award inst. 1983 by Tilak Smarak Trust

101. Nita Ambani – Ranked No. 1 in Fortune India's Most Powerful Women 2026 list; received AAPI Humanitarian Award in Florida, USA

102. Bharat Samman 2026 – Nandini Azad; honoured for women empowerment; President of Working Women's Forum (WWF-I)

103. Fields Medal 2026 – Awarded to Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman & Hong Wang; Hong Wang became 3rd woman to receive it; first awarded in 1936, every 4 years

104. WSIS Prizes 2026 Global Award – DoT's Samriddh Gram won; under Action Line C6: Enabling Environment by ITU; built on BharatNet infrastructure

105. FIU – IND – Runner-up at Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026; uncovered ₹868 crore cyber fraud and money laundering network

▶ RANKS & REPORTS

106. Global Passport Index 2026 – Sweden topped; India slipped to 125th; Indian passport gives visa-free access to 26 destinations; Singapore = only non-European in top 10

107. EIU Global Liveability Index 2026 – Copenhagen most liveable; New Delhi ranked 120th; index assesses 173 cities

108. NITI Aayog Investment Friendliness Index 2026 – Gujarat 1st, Maharashtra 2nd, Tamil Nadu 3rd; 17 states assessed across 84 indicators under 8 pillars

109. IAF Global Air Power Rankings WDMMA 2026 – India ranked 3rd for 5th consecutive year; behind USA and Russia; IAF operates 1,716 aircraft

110. UN World Investment Report – India 11th-largest FDI recipient in 2025; FDI inflows up 44% to $38.89 billion; UNCTAD HQ Geneva

111. Happy City Index 2026 – Bath (England) topped; Jaipur ranked 6th globally (only Indian city in top 10); Pink City, capital of Rajasthan

112. Brand Finance India 100 2026 – Tata Group: most valuable brand for 10th consecutive year; Adani entered top 10 first time; Taj Hotels: strongest brand

113. WIPO Intangible Asset Report – India recorded highest growth (7.9%) in intangible investment among world's 15 largest economies; software & databases: 45%

114. BIMCO – ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026 – India: 2nd largest supplier of seafarers (3,11,936; 12.16%); behind Philippines

115. India Railway Electrification – 99.6% Broad Gauge network electrified; India 2nd globally (Switzerland 100%); 1,161 MW solar, 103 MW wind commissioned by June 2026

116. India SDG Index 2026 – Rank 94 out of 169 countries; score 68.3; improved from 99 in previous year; Finland topped; report by UN SDSN

▶ SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

117. ISRO CE20 cryogenic engine – Hot test for LVM3-M7 mission with 22-tonne thrust at ISRO Propulsion Complex, Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu

118. Gaganyaan parachute test – ISRO tested main parachute system at ADRDE drop zone, Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh using IAF IL-76 aircraft

119. Gaganyaan three system tests – ISRO tested uprighting system, umbilical separation, and apex cover separation; for astronaut safety during splashdown

120. Mission PRAXIS (NASA) – AI-powered mission concept to collect samples from Saturn's rings; PRAXIS = Planetary Rings Autonomous Exploration with In-situ Sampling; NIAC Phase-I

121. SpaceX Starship 13th test – Deployed 20 Starlink satellites using V3 version; NASA evaluating for Artemis Moon missions; Founder & CEO: Elon Musk

122. JAXA reusable rocket – Japan's first reusable rocket lift-off and landing test in Noshiro, Akita; reached 10 metres altitude; 40-second flight; JAXA est. 2003

123. NASA astronaut Anil Menon – Reached ISS aboard Soyuz MS-29; first spaceflight; mission lasts ~8 months; ISS joint project of NASA, Roscosmos, ESA, JAXA, CSA

124. China Haiyang – 2E satellite – Oceanographic research satellite launched on Long March-4B; for marine monitoring, weather forecasting, ocean research

125. NVIDIA Open Secure AI Alliance – 37 members; open-sourced NOOA framework; members include Microsoft, Cisco, IBM, Cloudflare; Apache 2.0 licence

126. IIT Delhi – DRDO aerostat – Indigenous tactical aerostat capable of carrying surveillance payloads up to 20 km altitude

127. PinS helicopter procedure – India's first Point-in-Space Instrument Approach Procedure at Undavalli Heliport; developed by AAI, approved by DGCA

128. India hydrogen train 'Namo Green Rail' – India's first hydrogen train inaugurated by PM Modi in Jind, Haryana; India is 5th country after Germany, China, Japan, USA

▶ DEFENCE

129. INS Mahendragiri – 6th Project 17A stealth frigate; commissioned into Eastern Fleet; 75%+ indigenous content; equipped with BrahMos missiles; commissioned at Visakhapatnam

130. Kusha LR – SAM – DRDO's maiden flight test of Kusha Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile; tested at Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha; destroys aircraft, missiles & UAVs

131. DAC approval ₹52,000 crore – Defence Acquisition Council chaired by Rajnath Singh; includes Akash Tarang, MPATGM, MRSAM, V-SHORADS, drones & naval systems

132. Samudra Pradakshina – India's first tri-service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition; 9 women officers; 314-day voyage; 25,500 nautical miles across 4 oceans; aboard IASV Triveni

133. INS Malvan – Second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC); built by Cochin Shipyard Ltd.; commissioned at Karwar, Karnataka

134. Exercise Pitch Black 2026 – IAF participated at RAAF Base Darwin, Australia (20 July – 7 August); deployed Rafale fighters, C-17 Globemaster III, IL-78 aircraft; biennial exercise

135. Pinaka LRGR – DRDO tested Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket at ITR Chandipur, Odisha; minimum range 60 km; Pinaka is a multi-barrel rocket launcher system

136. ICGS Akshay – New-generation Fast Patrol Vessel commissioned at Goa; built by Goa Shipyard Limited; Indian Coast Guard established in 1978

▶ SCHEMES & PROGRAMMES

137. Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) – ₹62,500 crore outlay; FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31; India is 2nd largest mobile manufacturer by volume

138. Semicon 2.0 – ₹1,27,500 crore outlay; focuses on design, fabs, ATMP/OSAT, R&D; builds on Semicon 1.0; ISM launched in 2021 under Digital India

139. EPFO VISHWAS 2026 – One-time dispute resolution scheme; open for 6 months; covers defaults before 14 June 2024; apply online via EPFO Employer Portal

140. DISHA 2.0 – ₹255 crore outlay (2026-31); 4 components: Tele-Law, Nyaya Bandhu, LLLAP, VIDHI-Sanjeevani; integrates Nyaya Setu AI chatbot

141. Mission Golden Spice – Launched for GI-tagged Lakadong Turmeric in Meghalaya; ₹175.45 crore; 2025-2030 in two phases

142. PARIVARTAN Scheme – Approved by MoHUA; replaces old commercial vehicles in NCR; promotes BS-VI compliant & electric trucks/buses; ₹9,585 crore outlay

143. PLI Scheme achievement – Over ₹2.40 trillion investment and 1.415 million jobs till March 2026; exports worth ₹15.2 trillion; launched in 2020

144. BBBP Sex Ratio improvement – Sex Ratio at Birth improved from 918 (2014-15) to 929 (2024-25); under Mission Shakti; BBBP launched on 22 January 2015 at Panipat

145. PM Vidyalaxmi – Collateral-free & guarantor-free education loans for students in top QHEIs; 3% interest subvention for income ≤ ₹8 lakh; launched November 2024

146. DWEEPTI Yojana (Chhattisgarh) – First state with women-led distributed renewable energy policy; DWEEPTI = Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion

147. EPF Scheme 2026 – Notified under Code on Social Security, 2020; replaces EPF Scheme, 1952; interest rate maintained at 8.25% for FY 2025-26

148. PM – JANMAN – Launched 15 November 2023 on Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas; for 75 PVTG communities; covers 18 States & 1 UT; 11 interventions by 9 Ministries

▶ AGREEMENTS & MoUs

149. Corporate Mitra Scheme (MCA + IIT Madras) – To train & certify para professionals for MSME business compliance; announced in Union Budget 2026-27

150. PNB + AP Quantum Mission – India's first Quantum Finance Innovation Hub at Amaravati; PNB is first Indian bank to partner with a state govt for quantum finance

151. Australia – India PACTS – Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains; replaces 2020 Framework; 5 pillars: Supply Chain, Critical Technology, Cybersecurity, Digital Resilience, Defence Research

152. Mission ShakthiSAT – World's first all-girls international lunar satellite mission; 12,000 girls from 108 countries; GBU + Space Kidz India + IN-SPACe partnership

153. IIT Bombay + SBI Life – Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance; SBI Life is JV between SBI and BNP Paribas Cardif

154. Akasa Air + BPCL – MoU for Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF); aligns with ICAO's CORSIA sustainability framework

155. PNB + BHASHINI – Multilingual AI-powered banking services; customers access services in preferred Indian languages; BHASHINI is MeitY initiative

156. DoT + Madhya Pradesh – 350-acre Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ) in Gwalior; expected investment ₹12,000-15,000 crore; 14,000 direct jobs

157. IIT Delhi + Sorbonne University – Joint Master's and PhD programme; begins with Biological Sciences; also covers AI, Robotics, Computer Science; Sorbonne University, Paris, France

158. NABARD + MAHAPREIT – Green and climate-resilient rural infrastructure; for Panchayati Raj Institutions; NABARD est. 12 July 1982

▶ ENVIRONMENT

159. Sarnath UNESCO World Heritage Site – India's 45th; 4th from Uttar Pradesh (after Taj Mahal-1983, Agra Fort-1983, Fatehpur Sikri-1986); announced at 48th WHC, Busan, South Korea

160. Borjuli Wetland (Assam) – Declared Biodiversity Heritage Site for wild rice (Oryza rufipogon), the wild ancestor of Oryza sativa; under Biological Diversity Act, 2002

161. Cyttopsis indica (Indian dory) – New deep-sea fish discovered by CMFRI in Arabian Sea off Kerala; at depth 350-500 metres in Lakshadweep Sea; confirmed via DNA analysis

162. Elaphropoda triangulata & Habropoda adi – Two new solitary bee species discovered by ATREE in Arunachal Pradesh; Anthophorinae subfamily; ground-nesting pollinators

163. Lestes paloti – New spreadwing damselfly species in Kerala's Western Ghats; first new Lestes species from India since 1987; first from Western Ghats since 1929; endemic to WG

164. Microporellus kolhapurensis – New polypore (bracket) fungus discovered in Kolhapur, Maharashtra; found in Bhudargad taluka on rotting wood; published in Nelumbo (BSI journal)

▶ INDIA & WORLD

165. PM Modi Seychelles visit – Exchanged 9 MoUs covering UPI, health, agriculture, shipping, space, extradition, and ₹1,250 crore Line of Credit; visited 27-29 June 2026

166. PM Modi Indonesia visit – First Indian PM to address Indonesia's Parliament; 14 MoUs signed; Tagore-Dewantara Year 2027; IIM Bangalore campus at Singhasari SEZ announced

167. India – Japan Summit – 16th Annual Summit during PM Takaichi Sanae's visit (1-3 July 2026); 3 key documents on Economic Security, AI and Energy Resilience

168. India – Israel BIA – Bilateral Investment Agreement came into force on 4 July 2026; signed on 8 September 2025 in New Delhi

169. Trump 10% tariff on Indian goods – USA imposed 10% tariff over forced labour concerns; India avoided proposed 12.5% tariff by amending Foreign Trade Policy (14 July 2026)

170. India – Costa Rica JETCO – First Joint Economic and Trade Committee Meeting held virtually on 6-7 July 2026; bilateral trade ~USD 391 million in FY 2025-26

171. APEDA Makhana export – First-ever sea shipment of value-added flavoured Makhana from Bihar (Darbhanga) to Canada via Mundra Port; 7 metric tonnes

172. India – Romania 3 MoUs – Science & Technology, Education, and Sports; during President Droupadi Murmu's State Visit; target to double bilateral trade in 3 years

173. India TKDL – Australia patent – CSIR and IP Australia signed agreement to access Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL); prevents wrongful patents; TKDL est. 2001

174. India – Panama maritime partnership – Cooperation in maritime security, shipping, logistics, and digital transformation; Panama Canal connects Atlantic and Pacific Oceans

▶ ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

175. RCB acquisition – CCI approved ₹16,660 crore all-cash deal by Aditya Birla Group, Times Group, Bolt Ventures & Blackstone; RCB earlier owned by United Spirits Ltd.

176. Kotak + Deutsche Bank India – Kotak Mahindra Bank to acquire retail banking & wealth management business for ₹281.7 crore; includes ₹29,000 cr loan book

177. Aviva Life Insurance – To become first foreign insurer to own 100% of Indian life insurance company; acquires remaining 26% from Dabur Invest Corp; FDI limit raised to 100% in 2026

178. Fairfax + IDBI Bank – $5.5 billion deal; part of IDBI Bank privatisation; Fairfax led by Prem Watsa; IDBI Bank jointly owned by Government of India & LIC

179. Patanjali Ayurved + DS Group + Magma General Insurance – IRDAI approved; Patanjali gets 73.56%, DS Group gets 24.50%; deal valued at ₹4,500 crore

▶ IMPORTANT DAYS

180. 1 July – National Doctors Day (birth & death anniversary of Dr B.C. Roy); National Chartered Accountants Day (ICAI Foundation Day – 77th in 2026; est. 1949)

181. 4 July – International Day of Cooperatives (first Saturday of July); Theme 2026: 'Cooperatives for a peaceful world'

182. 7 July – World Kiswahili Language Day; UNESCO recognizes it as first African language with own international day

183. 11 July – World Population Day; Theme 2026: 'Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people'; World Horse Day (UNGA Resolution 79/291, adopted 3 June 2025)

184. 15 July – World Youth Skills Day; Theme 2026: 'Skills for a shared future'; declared by UNGA in 2014

185. 18 July – Nelson Mandela International Day (his birth anniversary); declared by UN in 2009; promotes justice, equality, human rights, dignity & peace

186. 20 July – World Chess Day (marking founding of FIDE in 1924); International Moon Day (Apollo 11 landing 20 July 1969)

187. 22 July – Pi Approximation Day (22/7 = π ≈ 3.14); World Brain Day; Theme 2026: 'Healthy Brain for a Healthy Society'

188. 23 July – National Broadcasting Day; commemorates India's first radio broadcast in 1927 from Bombay Station; Indian State Broadcasting Service renamed AIR on 8 June 1936

189. 26 July – Kargil Vijay Diwas (27th in 2026); commemorates India's victory in 1999 Kargil War under Operation Vijay; International Day for Conservation of Mangrove Ecosystem (UNESCO)

190. 28 July – World Hepatitis Day; Theme: 'Hepatitis: Let's Break It Down'; birth anniversary of Dr. Baruch Blumberg (discoverer of Hepatitis B virus); World Nature Conservation Day

191. 30 July – International Day of Friendship (UN General Assembly, 2011); World Day Against Trafficking in Persons; Theme 2026: 'Trapped Behind the Scam' (UNODC)

▶ SUMMITS & CONFERENCES

192. 16th India – Japan Annual Summit – During Japanese PM Takaichi Sanae's visit (1-3 July 2026); 3 key documents on Economic Security, AI and Energy Resilience

193. BRICS Women Working Group Meeting – Hosted by India in Kochi, Kerala (6-7 July 2026); under India's BRICS Chairship 2026; India's BRICS theme: 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'

194. BRICS Women Ministerial Meeting – Concluded in Kochi; first-ever Joint Statement adopted under BRICS Women Track

195. 10th India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026 – Theme: 'Scale without Boundaries'; New Delhi, 7-10 October 2026; organised by DoT & COAI; 4 pillars: Srishti, Suraksha, Sashakt & Samvardhan

196. UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance (Geneva) – India's delegation led by MoS External Affairs Kirti Vardhan Singh; forum under UNGA Resolution 79/325; Global Digital Compact adopted at UN Summit of Future (2024)

197. Saushrutam 2026 – Inaugurated by President Droupadi Murmu at AIIA, New Delhi on Sushruta Jayanti; Acharya Sushruta is Father of Surgery

198. 10th NCORD Apex Meeting – Chaired by HM Amit Shah; released Vision Document on Narcotics Control 2026-2029; NCB functions under MHA

▶ OBITUARY

199. Teejan Bai – Legendary Pandavani folk singer; passed away at 70; received Padma Shri, Padma Bhushan & Padma Vibhushan; Pandavani is folk art of Chhattisgarh from Mahabharata

200. S. Janaki – 'Nightingale of the South'; playback singer; passed away at 88; sang ~48,000 songs; won National Film Award; Padma Bhushan in 2013

201. Sir Garfield Sobers – West Indies cricket legend; passed away at 89; scored 8032 runs in 93 Tests; record 365 against Pakistan in 1958; one of cricket's greatest all-rounders

202. Girish Bharadwaj – 'Bridge Man of India'; Padma Shri (2017); passed away at 76; built 300+ low-cost suspension bridges across India

203. Tshering Choden – Sikkim mountaineer; scaled Mount Elbrus (5,642 m), highest peak in Europe; her 2nd summit in Seven Summits Challenge

204. Kevin Keegan – England football legend; passed away at 75; won Ballon d'Or twice (1978 & 1979); played for Liverpool & Hamburger SV

▶ INSURANCE

205. Prudential HCL Health Insurance – IRDAI granted registration as standalone health insurer; JV between Prudential Group (UK) & HCL Group (India); total standalone health insurers in India: 8

206. Aviva Life Insurance – First foreign insurer to own 100% of Indian life insurance company; FDI limit in insurance sector raised from 74% to 100% in 2026

207. IRDAI approval – Magma General Insurance acquisition by Patanjali Ayurved (73.56%) & DS Group (24.50%); deal worth ₹4,500 crore; valid for 3 months from 28 July 2026

208. Cooperative life insurance company – Government to launch cooperative life insurance company and utility aggregator cooperative; Bharat Taxi to expand to 500+ cities

▶ APPS & PORTALS

209. FCRA 2.0 Portal & e – OCI Card – Launched by Amit Shah; FCRA 2.0 enables end-to-end online processing; e-OCI Card eliminates physical OCI booklet reissue after age 20

210. TribeX – India's first digital learning platform for tribal arts, culture, traditional knowledge & skills; Ministry of Tribal Affairs; 20 free certificate courses initially

211. CITES 2.01 (EPFO) – Upgraded platform migrating 340 million member accounts to single centralised database; EPF interest for FY 2025-26 credited by 15 July 2026

212. Nalam TN – AI-powered WhatsApp chatbot for online OP registration at government hospitals in Tamil Nadu; send 'Hi' to 9619222999; operational in 22 districts

213. SWIFT Blockchain Platform – Enables 24×7 cross-border payments using tokenised deposits; 17 global banks piloting including HSBC, Citigroup, BNY Mellon

214. SAMARTH Panchayat Portal – Digital management of Own Source Revenue (OSR); part of Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme (350 revenue projects in 2026-30); Ministry received NAeG Gold Award

215. e – VSP Portal – Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal launched for digital access to legal publications in Hindi; offers SC & HC judgments, legal journals

216. Kaushal Setu & Kaushal Sarathi – Uttar Pradesh; Kaushal Setu for paperless registration of training partners; Kaushal Sarathi enables youth to locate training centres via digital map

▶ STATES & UTs

217. Pillale Sampada (Andhra Pradesh) – 'Children are Wealth' initiative; promotes population conservation; focuses on women's education, maternal & child healthcare and balanced growth; launched by CM N. Chandrababu Naidu

218. Assam Budget 2026 – 27 – ₹2,85,084 crore; fiscal deficit target 3% of projected GSDP; tea growers' agricultural income tax exemption raised from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹10 lakh; FM: Jayanta Malla Baruah

219. Gujarat Unjha GI Tag – Unjha cumin and fennel received Geographical Indication tag; India is world's largest producer and exporter of cumin; GI tags granted under Act of 1999

220. Greenfield Shipbuilding Cluster – Approved at Porbandar, Gujarat; 2,000 acres; capacity 1.2-1.5 million gross tonnage annually; developed by NSHIP-Gujarat (SPV of MoPSW & Gujarat Maritime Board)

221. Killai Climate Resilient Village – Tamil Nadu's first fully operational CRV under TNCCM; Cuddalore district; ecosystem restoration, renewable energy & community-led adaptation; near Pichavaram Mangrove Forest

222. Bhadarsa renamed Bharat Nagar (UP) – Ayodhya district; CM Yogi Adityanath renamed after Lord Ram's brother Bharat; located near Bharat Kund

223. Clean Air, Healthy Delhi – ₹8,300 crore outlay for 2026-2033; World Bank-supported; phases out old vehicles, promotes EVs; CAQM is statutory body for air quality in NCR

224. Pink Saheli Smart Card (Delhi) – Mandatory from 1 August 2026 for free bus travel in DTC buses; replaces paper-based pink ticket system; 11 lakh cards already issued

▶ COMMITTEES

225. SEBI Expert Working Group (EWG) – Constituted to review regulatory framework for debenture trustees; chaired by Ananta Barua (former SEBI Whole-Time Member); co-chaired by Rajnish Kumar (former SBI Chairman)

226. CCRAS 5th Executive Committee Meeting – Launched Research Methodology Textbook, CCRAS PRAYATNA 2026-27, and CCRAS Digital Ecosystem Dashboard; CCRAS is apex Ayurveda research body under Ministry of Ayush (est. 2014)



Multiple Choice Questions

For UPSC • State PCS • Banking • SSC • Railway • Govt Exams

◆ BANKING & FINANCE

Q1. Which fintech company launched Google Pay Card Payments for Indian merchants enabling international transactions?

a) Razorpay
b) PayGlocal
c) PayU
d) BillDesk

✓ Answer: b) PayGlocal

Explanation: PayGlocal launched Google Pay Card Payments, enabling Indian merchants to accept both Google Pay and Apple Pay globally. Google Pay operates in 86+ countries across 60+ currencies.

Q2. Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank achieved which RBI status after deposits surpassed ₹2,000 crore?

a) Tier-I UCB
b) Tier-II UCB
c) Tier-III UCB
d) Tier-IV UCB

✓ Answer: c) Tier-III UCB

Explanation: Tier-III UCBs are those with deposits between ₹1,000 crore and ₹10,000 crore. Kakinada Bank reported zero Net NPA and ₹16.18 crore net profit.

Q3. UPI was launched in Greece through which partnership, witnessed by Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal?

a) SBI-Piraeus Bank
b) Eurobank-NIPL
c) RBI-Bank of Greece
d) NPCI-Piraeus

✓ Answer: b) Eurobank-NIPL

Explanation: NIPL (NPCI International Payments Limited) is the international arm of NPCI. The launch enables instant, secure, low-cost digital payments in Greece.

Q4. Which bank became the first issuer of Visa Payment Passkey in India, enabling OTP-less authentication?

a) HDFC Bank
b) Kotak Mahindra Bank

c) IDFC FIRST Bank

d) Axis Bank

✓ **Answer: c) IDFC FIRST Bank**

Explanation: Visa Passkeys use FIDO-based public-key cryptography. The feature is available at select merchants like Myntra and Paytm.

Q5. NPCI partnered with which two institutions to boost overseas UPI payments with real-time forex conversion?

a) Citibank & Barclays

b) HSBC India & JP Morgan Payments

c) Standard Chartered & DBS

d) Deutsche Bank & UBS

✓ **Answer: b) HSBC India & JP Morgan Payments**

Explanation: The tie-up enables users to view the exact amount in rupees before making payments. UPI is now accepted in 9 countries for cross-border QR payments.

Q6. RBI imposed ₹63.6 lakh penalty on Bank of Baroda primarily for violation of which norms?

a) Basel III norms

b) Priority Sector Lending

c) Fair Practices Code and KYC norms

d) CRR/SLR norms

✓ **Answer: c) Fair Practices Code and KYC norms**

Explanation: The bank also charged higher interest than the contracted rate in some loan accounts. GIC Housing Finance was separately fined ₹3.1 lakh.

Q7. Paytm Europe Payments received a Payment Institution Licence in Luxembourg from which regulatory body?

a) ECB

b) FCA

c) CSSF

d) BaFin

✓ **Answer: c) CSSF**

Explanation: CSSF stands for Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier, Luxembourg's financial regulator. Paytm Europe is a wholly-owned subsidiary of One 97 Communications.

Q8. RBI's Financial Inclusion Index rose to how much in FY26, up from 67 in FY25?

a) 68

b) 70

c) 72

d) 75

✓ **Answer: b) 70**

Explanation: RBI launched the Financial Inclusion Index in 2021. It is based on three pillars: Access, Usage, and Quality. Growth was driven mainly by higher usage of financial services.

Q9. NSE launched Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs) backed by gold stored in which type of facility?

a) RBI-registered vaults

b) SEBI-accredited vaults

c) MOF-approved vaults

d) BIS-certified vaults

✓ **Answer: b) SEBI-accredited vaults**

Explanation: EGRs represent physical gold in dematerialised form and allow seamless conversion between physical and digital gold. They are traded on stock exchanges like other demat securities.

Q10. Glomo became India's first non-bank acquirer to secure Visa Principal Membership. Glomo is a regulated payment service provider at which financial hub?

a) SEEPZ SEZ
b) GIFT IFSC
c) BKC Mumbai
d) Hyderabad HITECH City

✓ **Answer: b) GIFT IFSC**

Explanation: GIFT IFSC is India's first International Financial Services Centre, located in Gandhinagar, Gujarat. Glomo can now process direct Visa card payments and cross-border merchant settlements.

Q11. Federal Bank received its first international issuer credit rating from S&P. What rating was assigned?

a) BB+/Stable
b) BBB/Positive
c) BBB-/Stable
d) A-/Stable

✓ **Answer: c) BBB-/Stable**

Explanation: BBB- is the lowest investment-grade long-term credit rating by S&P. S&P also assigned an A-3 short-term rating to Federal Bank.

Q12. Bank of Maharashtra launched 'FinSpark 26', a national-level hackathon focused on which domain?

a) Agricultural Finance
b) Banking Cyber Risks and Fraud Prevention
c) Digital Currency
d) Green Finance

✓ **Answer: b) Banking Cyber Risks and Fraud Prevention**

Explanation: The hackathon is open to students and dropouts across India. Winners will compete in the grand finale at Pune with a prize pool of ₹10 lakh+. Bank of Maharashtra is headquartered in Pune.

Q13. The government approved issuance of polymer banknotes of which denominations for field trials?

a) ₹50 & ₹100
b) ₹10 & ₹20
c) ₹5 & ₹10
d) ₹100 & ₹200

✓ **Answer: b) ₹10 & ₹20**

Explanation: The government approved 1 billion ₹10 & ₹20 polymer notes for field trials. India first tested polymer notes in 2012. The first country to use polymer notes was Australia in 1988.

Q14. SBI plans to issue India's first rupee-denominated perpetual bonds of 2026 under which Basel framework?

a) Tier-2 capital bonds
b) Additional Tier-I (AT-1) bonds
c) Tier-3 capital bonds
d) Supplementary Capital bonds

✓ **Answer: b) Additional Tier-I (AT-1) bonds**

Explanation: SBI plans to issue ₹5,000 crore perpetual bonds with a 5-year call option. AT-1 bonds count as Additional Tier-I Capital Instruments under Basel III.

Q15. Who was appointed as liquidator of Paytm Payments Bank by the Delhi High Court?

a) T. Rabi Sankar
b) Girikumar M. Nair
c) S.K. Mohanty
d) Rajiv Rajan

✓ **Answer: b) Girikumar M. Nair**

Explanation: Girikumar M. Nair is a former SBI Chief GM. The liquidation process is governed under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, initiated after RBI cancelled Paytm Payments Bank's licence.

◆ ECONOMY

Q16. Union Cabinet approved how much additional investment in NIIF, taking the total commitment to ₹60,000 crore?

a) ₹10,000 crore
b) ₹20,000 crore
c) ₹30,000 crore
d) ₹40,000 crore

✓ **Answer: c) ₹30,000 crore**

Explanation: NIIF was established in 2015. The funds will support NIIF Infrastructure Fund II, with focus sectors being Transport, Energy, Digital Infrastructure and E-mobility.

Q17. IMF projected India's FY27 GDP growth at what percentage, making it among the fastest-growing major economies?

a) 5.9%
b) 6.4%
c) 6.8%
d) 7.2%

✓ **Answer: b) 6.4%**

Explanation: Growth is projected to be driven by private consumption and the services sector. Global growth is projected at 3.0% in 2026. IMF is headquartered in Washington, D.C., USA.

Q18. ADB cut India's FY27 GDP forecast to 6.6%, citing which primary reason?

a) Monsoon failure
b) West Asia tensions and higher energy prices
c) Slowdown in exports
d) Fiscal tightening

✓ **Answer: b) West Asia tensions and higher energy prices**

Explanation: ADB was established in 1966. FY28 growth forecast was retained at 7.3%. India is still expected to be the fastest-growing major Asian economy.

Q19. ADB approved a ₹230 million loan to modernise water supply in which Indian city, which will become the first to have a ring-main water supply system?

a) Mumbai
b) Kolkata
c) Chennai
d) Bengaluru

✓ **Answer: c) Chennai**

Explanation: The project will benefit 4.5 million residents and build 170+ km of water and sewer pipelines. AMRUT 2.0 stands for Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation 2.0.

Q20. India's outward FDI fell 47.9% YoY to how much in June 2026, according to RBI data?

a) $2 billion
b) $3 billion
c) $4 billion
d) $5 billion

✓ **Answer: b) $3 billion**

Explanation: It also declined from $4.5 billion in May 2026. Outward FDI includes equity, debt, and guarantees. FY26 outward FDI commitments stood at $48.6 billion.

Q21. CBDT raised the Cost Inflation Index (CII) to what figure for financial year 2026-27?

a) 376
b) 380
c) 384
d) 390

✓ **Answer: c) 384**

Explanation: Previous year's CII was 376. CII is used to calculate long-term capital gains. Indexation benefit has been removed for most assets transferred after 23 July 2024. CBDT functions under the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance.

Q22. NSE launched India's first domestic benchmark-based natural gas futures with contract symbol NATGASIND. These futures are based on which hub price?

a) Hazira Hub
b) Dahej Hub (IGX Gujarat)
c) Kakinada Hub
d) Mundra Hub

✓ **Answer: b) Dahej Hub (IGX Gujarat)**

Explanation: Approved by SEBI, these are cash-settled commodity derivatives. Indian Gas Exchange (IGX) is India's first automated national gas trading platform. NSE was established in 1992.

Q23. World Bank approved how much for India's rooftop solar programme PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana?

a) $600 million
b) $750 million
c) $890 million
d) $1 billion

✓ **Answer: c) $890 million**

Explanation: The scheme targets 1 crore (10 million) households and is expected to create 1.7 million jobs. PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana was launched in 2024.

Q24. India's Q1 FY27 exports rose by what percentage to USD 232.7 billion on strong merchandise growth?

a) 8.5%
b) 11.4%
c) 13.2%
d) 15.9%

✓ **Answer: b) 11.4%**

Explanation: Merchandise exports increased 15.9% to USD 129.3 billion. Imports rose 17.6% to USD 270.2 billion. Trade deficit widened to USD 37.4 billion. DGFT functions under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry.

◆ NATIONAL

Q25. India's first dengue vaccine QDENGA, approved by CDSCO, was developed by which company?

a) Serum Institute
b) Bharat Biotech
c) Takeda (Japan)
d) Pfizer

✓ Answer: c) Takeda (Japan)

Explanation: QDENGA protects against all four dengue virus serotypes. CDSCO is India's national drug regulatory authority under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.

Q26. Which museum, named 'Shabdalok', was inaugurated by Amit Shah as India's first immersive language museum?

a) In Mumbai
b) In New Delhi
c) In Kolkata
d) In Bhopal

✓ Answer: c) In Kolkata

Explanation: Shabdalok (Museum of Word) was developed by the National Library under the Ministry of Culture. It showcases India's 22 official languages using immersive digital technology. National Library of India is located in Kolkata.

Q27. India commissioned its first two geothermal wells at Puga Valley in which Union Territory?

a) Jammu & Kashmir
b) Ladakh
c) Puducherry
d) Andaman Islands

✓ Answer: b) Ladakh

Explanation: The project was executed by ONGC Energy Centre. Two wells were drilled to a depth of 1,000 metres to support India's first 1 MW pilot geothermal power project.

Q28. NITI Aayog launched the Bioeconomy Roadmap 2035, targeting a USD 691 billion bioeconomy. It proposes which fund?

a) ₹25,000 crore BioTech Fund
b) ₹50,000 crore BioEconomy Growth Fund
c) ₹75,000 crore Green Fund
d) ₹1 lakh crore Innovation Fund

✓ Answer: b) ₹50,000 crore BioEconomy Growth Fund

Explanation: The roadmap aims to create 30 million+ high-value jobs. NITI Aayog was established on 1 January 2015 to replace the Planning Commission.

Q29. PM Modi announced a Task Force on Examination Reforms to strengthen the NTA system. Who chairs this task force?

a) S. Somnath

b) Nandan Nilekani
c) Tapan Deka
d) V. Kamakoti

✓ **Answer: b) Nandan Nilekani**

Explanation: The multidisciplinary committee also includes S. Somnath, Tapan Deka, V. Kamakoti, Anita Karwal and Amrit Lal Meena. NTA was established in 2018 under the Ministry of Education.

Q30. Kamarajar Port became India's second major port to offer an 18-metre draft after completing Capital Dredging Phase VI. Kamarajar Port is located in which state?

a) Andhra Pradesh
b) Maharashtra
c) Tamil Nadu
d) Gujarat

✓ **Answer: c) Tamil Nadu**

Explanation: The port can now handle Capesize vessels up to 1,70,000 DWT. Project cost was ₹440 crore. This development significantly boosts India's maritime capacity.

Q31. Mizoram's Natural History Museum was notified as which numbered Designated Repository under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002?

a) 18th
b) 19th
c) 20th
d) 21st

✓ **Answer: d) 21st**

Explanation: It will preserve authenticated biological specimens and strengthens biodiversity conservation in the Indo-Burma Biodiversity Hotspot. The National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) is headquartered in Chennai.

Q32. The DAANVEER initiative, launched to strengthen digital infrastructure in Gram Panchayats, is available through which app?

a) DigiGaon App
b) Meri Panchayat App
c) Grameen Digital App
d) E-Gram App

✓ **Answer: b) Meri Panchayat App**

Explanation: DAANVEER was launched by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj under the tagline 'Give Back to Your Village'. India has nearly 2.5 lakh Gram Panchayats.

Q33. Cabinet approved the National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026) to encourage new gas-based urea manufacturing. What is the introduced RoE band?

a) 8%-12%
b) 10%-14%
c) 12%-16%
d) 15%-20%

✓ **Answer: c) 12%-16%**

Explanation: India has 33 operational urea manufacturing units. The policy is expected to save over ₹250 crore per plant and supports Atmanirbhar Bharat.

Q34. MeitY launched NIDAR 2.0 under which initiative to develop drones using Indian-made chips?

a) PLI Scheme

b) SwaYaan initiative
c) Drone Shakti
d) Digital India Drone Mission

✓ **Answer: b) SwaYaan initiative**

Explanation: NIDAR 2.0 has a prize pool of ₹65 lakh+ and includes incubation, internships, and startup support. MeitY stands for Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

Q35. India launched its campaign for a UNSC non-permanent seat for which term?

a) 2026-27
b) 2027-28
c) 2028-29
d) 2029-30

✓ **Answer: c) 2028-29**

Explanation: The campaign was launched by External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar. India will compete with Tajikistan in the Asia-Pacific Group. Elections will be held in June 2027. The UN Security Council has 15 members.

Q36. Sarnath was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site during which session of the World Heritage Committee, increasing India's total to 45?

a) 46th Session
b) 47th Session
c) 48th Session
d) 49th Session

✓ **Answer: c) 48th Session**

Explanation: Announced at the 48th Session held in Busan, South Korea. Maratha Military Landscapes (2024) was the previous Indian inscription. Sarnath is where Lord Buddha delivered his first sermon.

◆ INTERNATIONAL

Q37. Which country became the first European nation to ban social media access for children below 15 years, with mandatory age verification by January 2027?

a) Germany
b) Sweden
c) France
d) Netherlands

✓ **Answer: c) France**

Explanation: France has become the first European country to impose this ban, requiring platforms to prevent underage users from creating or maintaining social media accounts. Capital: Paris | Currency: Euro.

Q38. Pakistan will host the 2027 South Asian Federation (SAF) Games. In which city were the first-ever SAF Games held in 1984?

a) Islamabad
b) Colombo
c) Dhaka
d) Kathmandu

✓ **Answer: d) Kathmandu**

Explanation: SAF Games were established in 1981. SAARC Secretariat is located in Kathmandu, Nepal. The games aim to strengthen SAARC regional cooperation.

Q39. Standard Chartered became the first bank in India to process a remittance under Swift's new retail payments scheme. The cross-border payment from Australia was completed in how many seconds?

a) 15 seconds
b) 25 seconds
c) 37 seconds
d) 60 seconds

✓ Answer: c) 37 seconds

Explanation: The transaction originated from Westpac (Australia) via the Swift network. SWIFT stands for Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication.

Q40. CAC49 adopted how many Codex standards developed under India's leadership, including a standard for cashew kernels?

a) 5
b) 7
c) 9
d) 11

✓ Answer: b) 7

Explanation: Indian delegation was led by Rajit Punhani, CEO, FSSAI. Standards adopted include dried coriander seeds and fresh curry leaves. Codex Alimentarius Commission was established by FAO and WHO in 1963.

Q41. Saudi Arabia and 13 other countries formed a Multinational Maritime Defence Coalition. Saudi Arabia will serve as the founding state with focus on which waterway?

a) Strait of Hormuz only
b) Bab el-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea & Gulf of Aden
c) Suez Canal region
d) Persian Gulf only

✓ Answer: b) Bab el-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea & Gulf of Aden

Explanation: The coalition is defensive in nature and operates under international law. Bab el-Mandeb Strait connects the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden.

◆ SPORTS

Q42. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became India's youngest international cricketer, breaking Sachin Tendulkar's record. At what age did Sooryavanshi debut?

a) 14 years 110 days
b) 15 years 99 days
c) 15 years 200 days
d) 16 years 15 days

✓ Answer: b) 15 years 99 days

Explanation: He debuted in the 2nd T20I vs England and received his debut cap from Tilak Varma. Sachin Tendulkar made his international debut in 1989 against Pakistan.

Q43. Australia won a record 7th Women's T20 World Cup title by defeating England in the final at Lord's, London. Who was the Player of the Tournament?

a) Sophie Molineux
b) Ellyse Perry
c) Beth Mooney
d) Meg Lanning

✓ **Answer: c) Beth Mooney**

Explanation: Beth Mooney was also the Player of the Match. Sophie Molineux won the title in her first tournament as captain. Australia defeated England by 7 wickets.

Q44. Jannik Sinner won the men's singles title at Wimbledon 2026. Who won the women's singles title, claiming her first Grand Slam?

a) Aryna Sabalenka
b) Iga Swiatek
c) Linda Noskova
d) Coco Gauff

✓ **Answer: c) Linda Noskova**

Explanation: Both champions received a record £3.6 million prize. Wimbledon is played on grass courts at the All England Club, London.

Q45. Spain won the 2026 FIFA World Cup defeating Argentina 1-0. Who scored the winning goal in extra time?

a) Rodri
b) Pedri
c) Ferran Torres
d) Gavi

✓ **Answer: c) Ferran Torres**

Explanation: The final was played at MetLife Stadium, New Jersey. Spain lifted its second FIFA World Cup title (first was in 2010). Lionel Messi became the first player to start three FIFA World Cup finals.

Q46. India won the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. Mirabai Chanu won India's first gold with what Commonwealth Games record total lift in women's 48 kg weightlifting?

a) 180 kg
b) 185 kg
c) 190 kg
d) 195 kg

✓ **Answer: c) 190 kg**

Explanation: Chanu became a three-time consecutive CWG gold medallist (2018, 2022, 2026). She won the silver medal in women's 49 kg weightlifting at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics (held in 2021).

Q47. PV Sindhu became the first Indian to win the Japan Open (BWF Super 750), ending a nearly two-year title drought. Who did she defeat in the final?

a) Carolina Marin
b) Tai Tzu-ying
c) Akane Yamaguchi
d) Se Young An

✓ **Answer: c) Akane Yamaguchi**

Explanation: Sindhu won her first BWF Super 750 title at the Japan Open, which is a BWF World Tour Super 750 tournament.

Q48. Aswath S. became India's how many Grandmaster (GM) in chess, achieving the title at the Pune International Round-Robin Chess Tournament?

a) 95th
b) 96th
c) 97th
d) 98th

✓ **Answer: d) 98th**

Explanation: He secured the GM title by winning his last three games and earned his third GM norm in Pune. FIDE stands for Fédération Internationale des Échecs (International Chess Federation).

Q49. Leander Paes was appointed Player Ambassador of the Asian Tennis Federation (ATF). How many Grand Slam titles has Paes won in his career?

a) 12
b) 15
c) 18
d) 20

✓ **Answer: c) 18**

Explanation: The announcement was made during the Wimbledon Championships. Paes was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame in 2024. ATF stands for Asian Tennis Federation.

Q50. India bagged 20 medals at Under-20 Asian Wrestling Championships held in Pattaya, Thailand. What was the medal tally?

a) 5G, 6S, 9B
b) 4G, 7S, 9B
c) 6G, 5S, 9B
d) 4G, 8S, 8B

✓ **Answer: b) 4G, 7S, 9B**

Explanation: India finished 2nd in women's and 3rd in men's freestyle team standings. Sumit Kumar Laxman Bharaskar won India's men's freestyle gold. United World Wrestling (UWW) is the global governing body for wrestling.

Q51. India won 4 gold medals at the 58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan. India finished joint first with which countries?

a) USA, South Korea & China
b) China, Vietnam & Russia
c) Japan, China & Germany
d) Russia, South Korea & USA

✓ **Answer: b) China, Vietnam & Russia**

Explanation: It was India's best-ever performance at the IChO. HBCSE, under TIFR, conducts India's selection and training for the International Chemistry Olympiad.

Q52. The BWF World Championships 2026 mascot 'Peacko' was unveiled by Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya. The event will be held in New Delhi from which dates?

a) 10-16 August
b) 17-23 August
c) 20-26 August
d) 24-30 August

✓ **Answer: b) 17-23 August**

Explanation: Peacko is inspired by the Indian Peafowl. The Indian Peafowl (Peacock) is the National Bird of India.

Q53. India won 5 gold medals at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026 held in Bucaramanga, Colombia, securing joint first position with which group of countries?

a) USA, China & Germany
b) Russia, China, Kazakhstan, South Korea and Taiwan
c) Japan, China & South Korea
d) USA, Russia & China

✓ **Answer: b) Russia, China, Kazakhstan, South Korea and Taiwan**

Explanation: The Olympiad saw participation from 381 students of 87 countries. HBCSE is a National Centre of TIFR and coordinates India's Science Olympiad programme.

◆ APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

Q54. Who was named as the part-time non-executive Chairman of HDFC Bank for 3 years, subject to RBI approval?

a) Deepak Parekh
b) Rajiv Kumar
c) Keki M. Mistry
d) Sashidhar Jagdishan

✓ **Answer: b) Rajiv Kumar**

Explanation: Rajiv Kumar is a former Finance Secretary and Chief Election Commissioner. He will succeed Keki M. Mistry. HDFC Bank was established in 1994 and is headquartered in Mumbai.

Q55. Viswanathan Anand took charge as Interim President of FIDE, succeeding which predecessor who was placed under EU sanctions?

a) Kirsan Ilyumzhinov
b) Nigel Short
c) Arkady Dvorkovich
d) Rustam Kasimdzhanov

✓ **Answer: c) Arkady Dvorkovich**

Explanation: FIDE (International Chess Federation) was established in 1924. Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland. Anand will serve until the sanctions on Dvorkovich are lifted.

Q56. Andy Burnham became the Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, succeeding Keir Starmer. He became the how-many-th PM of the UK?

a) 57th
b) 58th
c) 59th
d) 60th

✓ **Answer: c) 59th**

Explanation: He was invited by King Charles III to form the government. UK Capital: London | Currency: Pound Sterling.

Q57. Who was appointed CEO of NITI Aayog for 2 years, replacing Nidhi Chibber?

a) Amitabh Kant
b) Anurag Jain
c) BVR Subrahmanyam
d) Parameswaran Iyer

✓ **Answer: b) Anurag Jain**

Explanation: Anurag Jain is a 1989-batch IAS officer of the Madhya Pradesh cadre and earlier served as Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh. NITI Aayog was established on 1 January 2015.

Q58. Dharmendra Pradhan resigned as Union Education Minister taking responsibility for which issue?

a) JEE Advanced irregularities
b) NEET-UG 2026 paper leak
c) CUET disruption

d) UGC NET cancellation

✓ **Answer: b) NEET-UG 2026 paper leak**

Explanation: President Droupadi Murmu accepted his resignation. Pralhad Joshi was given additional charge of the Ministry of Education. Ministry of Education was renamed from MHRD in 2020 following NEP 2020.

Q59. Serhii Koretskyi was appointed Prime Minister of Ukraine. He was previously CEO of which organisation?

a) Ukrenergo
b) Ukrzaliznytsia
c) Naftogaz
d) Oschadbank

✓ **Answer: c) Naftogaz**

Explanation: Ukraine's Parliament approved his appointment with 289 votes. He was nominated by President Volodymyr Zelenskyy. Capital of Ukraine: Kyiv | Currency: Hryvnia.

Q60. Infosys appointed who as CEO-Designate, to assume roles from 1 April 2027, succeeding Salil Parekh?

a) Mohit Joshi
b) U.B. Pravin Rao
c) Ashiss Kumar Dash
d) Rajesh Murthy

✓ **Answer: c) Ashiss Kumar Dash**

Explanation: Dash currently serves as Executive Vice President and Global Head of Services. Infosys was founded in 1981 and is headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka.

◆ AWARDS

Q61. PM Narendra Modi received the 'Guardian of the Blue Horizon' Presidential Distinction from which country, for the first time this distinction was conferred?

a) Maldives
b) Mauritius
c) Seychelles
d) Sri Lanka

✓ **Answer: c) Seychelles**

Explanation: The award was conferred by President Dr. Patrick Herminie for promoting Blue Economy, climate action, and sustainable development. Capital of Seychelles: Victoria | Currency: Seychellois Rupee.

Q62. Which film won the Best Feature Film award at the 72nd National Film Awards for the year 2024?

a) Pushpa 2
b) Amaran
c) Article 370
d) Stree 2

✓ **Answer: c) Article 370**

Explanation: Yami Gautam won Best Actress. Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan shared the Best Actor award. Randeep Hooda won Best Debut Director for Swatantrya Veer Savarkar.

Q63. R. Vairamuthu was conferred the 60th Jnanpith Award (2025). He is the how-many-th Tamil writer to receive this honour?

a) First
b) Second
c) Third
d) Fourth

✓ **Answer: c) Third**

Explanation: The award carries ₹11 lakh, a bronze statue of Goddess Saraswati, and a citation. The Jnanpith Award was instituted in 1961 by Bharatiya Jnanpith.

Q64. NSA Ajit Doval was selected for the Lokmanya Tilak Award. This award is presented annually on which date?

a) 15 July
b) 1 August
c) 15 August
d) 2 October

✓ **Answer: b) 1 August**

Explanation: 1 August is the death anniversary of Bal Gangadhar Tilak. The Lokmanya Tilak Award was instituted in 1983 by the Tilak Smarak Trust. Ajit Doval is India's longest-serving National Security Advisor.

Q65. Fields Medal 2026 was awarded to four mathematicians. Who became the third woman to receive the Fields Medal?

a) Maryna Viazovska
b) Maryam Mirzakhani
c) Hong Wang
d) Karen Uhlenbeck

✓ **Answer: c) Hong Wang**

Explanation: Fields Medal 2026 was awarded to Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman & Hong Wang. The award is presented every 4 years to mathematicians below 40 years and was first awarded in 1936.

Q66. PM Narendra Modi received the Bintang Adipurna, Indonesia's highest civilian honour. This was awarded by which Indonesian President?

a) Joko Widodo
b) Prabowo Subianto
c) Megawati Sukarnoputri
d) Susilo Bambang Yudhoyono

✓ **Answer: b) Prabowo Subianto**

Explanation: The award was conferred during PM Modi's official visit to Indonesia. Capital of Indonesia: Jakarta | Currency: Indonesian Rupiah.

◆ RANKS & REPORTS

Q67. Which city topped the Global Passport Index 2026, while India slipped to 125th rank?

a) Finland
b) Denmark
c) Norway
d) Sweden

✓ **Answer: d) Sweden**

Explanation: Indian passport holders have visa-free/visa-on-arrival access to 26 destinations. Singapore was the only non-European country in the global top 10. The index evaluates 197 countries.

Q68. In the EIU Global Liveability Index 2026, which city was ranked the most liveable in the world while New Delhi ranked 120th?

a) Vienna
b) Zurich
c) Copenhagen
d) Melbourne

✓ Answer: c) Copenhagen

Explanation: The index assessed 173 cities worldwide. Mumbai (121), Chennai (123), and Bengaluru (127) also featured. The Global Liveability Index is published annually by the Economist Intelligence Unit.

Q69. Gujarat ranked 1st in NITI Aayog's first Investment Friendliness Index 2026. Which states ranked 2nd and 3rd?

a) Karnataka & Rajasthan
b) Maharashtra & Tamil Nadu
c) Andhra Pradesh & Telangana
d) Haryana & Uttar Pradesh

✓ Answer: b) Maharashtra & Tamil Nadu

Explanation: The index assessed 17 major states across 84 indicators under 8 pillars. Gujarat's strengths include policy stability, investor-friendly governance, and strong industrial infrastructure.

Q70. IAF ranked 3rd most powerful air force globally in the WDMMA 2026 Global Air Power Rankings for the fifth consecutive year. Which two countries ranked above India?

a) China & Russia
b) United States & China
c) United States & Russia
d) Russia & France

✓ Answer: c) United States & Russia

Explanation: The Indian Air Force was established on 8 October 1932. The IAF operates a fleet of 1,716 aircraft.

Q71. India rose to 11th position among top FDI destinations in 2025, according to a UN (UNCTAD) report. FDI inflows increased by what percentage to $38.89 billion?

a) 28%
b) 36%
c) 44%
d) 52%

✓ Answer: c) 44%

Explanation: India improved from 13th position in 2024. Alphabet Inc. announced the world's largest greenfield investment in India worth $14.5 billion. UNCTAD is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Q72. Tata Group was ranked India's most valuable brand for the 10th consecutive year in the Brand Finance India 100 2026 report. Which group entered the top 10 for the first time?

a) Reliance
b) Adani Group
c) Mahindra
d) Wipro

✓ Answer: b) Adani Group

Explanation: Infosys retained 2nd position. Taj Hotels remained India's strongest brand. Suzlon Energy was the fastest-growing brand.

Q73. India's Railway electrification has reached 99.6% of its Broad Gauge network. India ranks 2nd globally in railway electrification after which country?

a) Japan
b) Germany
c) Switzerland
d) France

✓ Answer: c) Switzerland

Explanation: Switzerland has 100% electrification. Indian Railways aims for 100% electrification of the BG network. Rail transport emits about 89% less CO_2 than road transport.

◆ SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Q74. ISRO conducted a hot test of the CE20 cryogenic engine with 22-tonne thrust for which upcoming mission?

a) LVM3-M6
b) LVM3-M7
c) GSLV-F15
d) PSLV-C60

✓ Answer: b) LVM3-M7

Explanation: The test was conducted at ISRO Propulsion Complex, Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu. LVM3 (GSLV MkIII) is ISRO's heaviest launch vehicle and uses the CE20 engine in its upper stage.

Q75. NASA unveiled Mission PRAXIS, an AI-powered concept mission to collect samples from Saturn's rings. What does PRAXIS stand for?

a) Planetary Research Autonomy eXtraction In-situ System
b) Planetary Rings Autonomous Exploration with In-situ Sampling
c) Probe Ring Autonomous eXploration Initiative System
d) Planetary Ring Analysis eXploration In-Space

✓ Answer: b) Planetary Rings Autonomous Exploration with In-situ Sampling

Explanation: Saturn is the 6th planet from the Sun. Mission is currently under NASA Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) Phase-I feasibility study.

Q76. SpaceX completed its 13th Starship test flight using the V3 version. How many advanced Starlink satellites were deployed?

a) 10
b) 15
c) 20
d) 25

✓ Answer: c) 20

Explanation: NASA is evaluating Starship for future Artemis Moon missions. SpaceX was founded by Elon Musk.

Q77. NASA astronaut Anil Menon reached the ISS aboard Soyuz MS-29. This was his first spaceflight and the mission will last approximately how long?

a) 3 months
b) 6 months
c) 8 months
d) 12 months

✓ Answer: c) 8 months

Explanation: Anil Menon reached ISS with two Russian cosmonauts. ISS is a joint project of NASA, Roscosmos, ESA, JAXA, and CSA.

Q78. India approved its first PinS (Point-in-Space) Instrument Approach Procedure for helicopter operations at which heliport?

a) Juhu Heliport
b) Rohini Heliport
c) Undavalli Heliport
d) Pawan Hans Heliport

✓ Answer: c) Undavalli Heliport

Explanation: The procedure was developed by AAI and approved by DGCA using satellite-based navigation technology. DGCA is the aviation safety regulator of India under the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

Q79. NVIDIA formed a 37-member Open Secure AI Alliance and open-sourced which AI framework?

a) CUDA AI Framework
b) NOOA (NVIDIA-labs OO Agents)
c) TensorRT
d) NeMo Framework

✓ Answer: b) NOOA (NVIDIA-labs OO Agents)

Explanation: Members include Microsoft, Cisco, IBM, Cloudflare, Red Hat, and Linux Foundation. Licensed under Apache 2.0 License. Alliance focuses on secure AI agents, AI software, and cybersecurity.

◆ DEFENCE

Q80. INS Mahendragiri, the sixth Project 17A stealth frigate, was commissioned into which Indian Navy fleet?

a) Western Fleet
b) Eastern Fleet
c) Southern Naval Command
d) Andaman & Nicobar Command

✓ Answer: b) Eastern Fleet

Explanation: Built with over 75% indigenous content, it is equipped with BrahMos missiles. Project 17A frigates are designed by the Warship Design Bureau (WDB) of the Indian Navy. Commissioned at Visakhapatnam.

Q81. DRDO conducted the maiden flight test of Kusha LR-SAM (Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile) at which test site?

a) Pokhran Test Range
b) ITR Chandipur
c) Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha
d) Mahendragiri Test Facility

✓ Answer: c) Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha

Explanation: Kusha LR-SAM can destroy aircraft, missiles, and UAVs. It intercepted a high-speed aerial target and reduces India's import dependence. Developed by DRDO, headquartered in New Delhi.

Q82. Rajnath Singh flagged-in 'Samudra Pradakshina', India's first tri-service all-women sailing expedition. How many women officers completed this 314-day voyage?

a) Five
b) Seven

c) Nine

d) Twelve

✓ **Answer: c) Nine**

Explanation: The voyage covered 25,500 nautical miles across four oceans. The expedition was conducted aboard Indian Army Sailing Vessel (IASV) Triveni.

Q83. Defence Acquisition Council, chaired by Rajnath Singh, approved defence acquisitions worth approximately ₹52,000 crore. Which missile system was included?

a) BRAHMOS only

b) MRSAM, V-SHORADS, Akash Tarang and others

c) Agni-V only

d) BrahMos & Prithvi

✓ **Answer: b) MRSAM, V-SHORADS, Akash Tarang and others**

Explanation: Procurement also includes MPATGM, drones, and naval systems. DAC was established in 2001 under the Ministry of Defence to accelerate defence procurement.

◆ SCHEMES & PROGRAMMES

Q84. Cabinet approved the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) with an outlay of ₹62,500 crore. From which fiscal year will it be implemented?

a) FY 2025-26 to FY 2029-30

b) FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31

c) FY 2027-28 to FY 2031-32

d) FY 2024-25 to FY 2028-29

✓ **Answer: b) FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31**

Explanation: The scheme aims to boost mobile manufacturing, exports and domestic value addition. India is the world's second-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume.

Q85. Cabinet approved Semicon 2.0 with an outlay of ₹1,27,500 crore to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem. India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) was launched in which year?

a) 2019

b) 2020

c) 2021

d) 2022

✓ **Answer: c) 2021**

Explanation: Semicon 2.0 focuses on design, fabs, ATMP/OSAT, R&D, materials, and talent development. It builds on the progress of Semicon 1.0. ISM was launched under the Digital India Programme.

Q86. EPFO launched VISHWAS 2026, a one-time dispute resolution scheme. It covers defaults before which date?

a) 14 March 2024

b) 14 June 2024

c) 14 September 2024

d) 14 December 2024

✓ **Answer: b) 14 June 2024**

Explanation: VISHWAS will remain open for six months. Applications are to be filed online through the EPFO Employer Portal using DSC/e-Sign. EPFO functions under the Ministry of Labour & Employment.

Q87. Centre launched DISHA 2.0 with ₹255 crore outlay (2026-31). Which AI chatbot is integrated with VIDHI-Sanjeevani for monitoring and legal assistance?

a) Nyaya AI
b) Samvidhan Bot
c) Nyaya Setu AI chatbot
d) Legal Assist AI

✓ Answer: c) Nyaya Setu AI chatbot

Explanation: DISHA 2.0 has 4 components: Tele-Law, Nyaya Bandhu, Legal Literacy & Legal Awareness Programme (LLLAP), and VIDHI-Sanjeevani. Tele-Law provides free pre-litigation legal advice through mobile app, Toll-Free 14454 and CSCs.

Q88. Chhattisgarh launched DWEEPTI Yojana, becoming the first state with a women-led distributed renewable energy policy. What does DWEEPTI stand for?

a) District Women Empowerment through Electricity and Power Technology Initiative
b) Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion
c) Digital Women Energy and Environment Policy for Transformative India
d) Distributed Women Electricity Empowerment Programme for Tribal Inclusion

✓ Answer: b) Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion

Explanation: It is implemented under PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana. SHGs will work as solar vendors, technicians, and entrepreneurs. Flagship district is Kabirdham.

Q89. The EPF Scheme 2026 was notified under the Code on Social Security, 2020, replacing the EPF Scheme, 1952. The EPF interest rate remains at what percentage for FY 2025-26?

a) 8.10%
b) 8.15%
c) 8.20%
d) 8.25%

✓ Answer: d) 8.25%

Explanation: EPFO functions under the Ministry of Labour & Employment. Existing balances and contribution structure remain unchanged.

Q90. Mission Golden Spice was launched for Lakadong Turmeric in Meghalaya with an outlay of ₹175.45 crore. Lakadong Turmeric is GI-tagged. What is the implementation period?

a) 2024-2029
b) 2025-2030
c) 2026-2031
d) 2027-2032

✓ Answer: b) 2025-2030

Explanation: The mission was launched by Jyotiraditya M. Scindia. It will be implemented in two phases. Lakadong Turmeric is a GI-tagged variety from Meghalaya.

◆ AGREEMENTS & MoUs

Q91. PNB partnered with the AP Quantum Mission to establish India's first Quantum Finance Innovation Hub at which location?

a) Visakhapatnam
b) Amaravati
c) Hyderabad
d) Tirupati

✓ Answer: b) Amaravati

Explanation: PNB becomes the first Indian bank to partner with a State government for a quantum finance facility. It will promote research in Quantum Computing, AI, and emerging technologies.

Q92. India and Australia launched PACTS (Australia-India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains). It replaces which previous framework?

a) 2015 Framework
b) 2018 Framework
c) 2020 Framework
d) 2022 Framework

✓ Answer: c) 2020 Framework

Explanation: PACTS focuses on five pillars: Supply Chain Resilience, Critical Technology, Cybersecurity, Digital Resilience, and Defence Research. Capital of Australia: Canberra.

Q93. Mission ShakthiSAT is described as the world's first all-girls international lunar satellite mission, involving 12,000 girls from how many countries?

a) 80 countries
b) 95 countries
c) 108 countries
d) 120 countries

✓ Answer: c) 108 countries

Explanation: GBU, Space Kidz India, and IN-SPACe partnered for this mission. IN-SPACe is headquartered in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. The mission aims to promote STEM education and women in space science.

Q94. IIT Bombay and SBI Life signed an MoU to establish the Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance. SBI Life Insurance is a joint venture between SBI and which company?

a) Allianz
b) Prudential
c) BNP Paribas Cardif
d) AIA Group

✓ Answer: c) BNP Paribas Cardif

Explanation: The hub will develop indigenous AI-based cybersecurity solutions to strengthen digital security in the insurance sector.

◆ IMPORTANT DAYS

Q95. World Population Day is observed on 11 July. What is the theme for 2026?

a) 'Health for All'
b) 'Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people – today and for the future'
c) 'Empowering Women Globally'
d) 'Leaving No One Behind'

✓ Answer: b) 'Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people – today and for the future'

Explanation: Established by the UNDP Governing Council in 1989. National Chartered Accountants Day is also observed on 1 July (ICAI Foundation Day).

Q96. Kargil Vijay Diwas is observed on 26 July. Which 'diwas' was being observed in 2026?

a) 25th
b) 26th
c) 27th

d) 28th

✓ **Answer: c) 27th**

Explanation: Kargil Vijay Diwas commemorates India's victory in the 1999 Kargil War under Operation Vijay. The Kargil War was fought between India and Pakistan in the Kargil sector of Ladakh.

Q97. World Day Against Trafficking in Persons is observed on 30 July. The 2026 theme was what?

a) 'Freedom for All'

b) 'Trapped Behind the Scam'

c) 'Together Against Trafficking'

d) 'No Safe Haven for Traffickers'

✓ **Answer: b) 'Trapped Behind the Scam'**

Explanation: It is led globally by UNODC. The theme highlights trafficking linked to cyber scams, forced criminality, and organised crime.

Q98. International Moon Day is observed on 20 July, commemorating which historical event?

a) India's Chandrayaan-3 landing

b) China's first Moon mission

c) Apollo 11 Moon landing in 1969

d) First satellite orbit of the Moon

✓ **Answer: c) Apollo 11 Moon landing in 1969**

Explanation: Observed following UN General Assembly Resolution 76/76 (2021). Apollo 11 astronauts Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin became the first humans to walk on the Moon. Michael Collins remained in lunar orbit.

◆ SUMMITS & CONFERENCES

Q99. The 16th India-Japan Annual Summit was held during which Japanese PM's official visit to India from 1-3 July 2026?

a) Fumio Kishida

b) Yoshihide Suga

c) Takaichi Sanae

d) Shigeru Ishiba

✓ **Answer: c) Takaichi Sanae**

Explanation: Both countries reaffirmed cooperation in defence, security, economic partnership, technology, energy resilience, and people-to-people exchanges. Japan's currency is the Japanese Yen (JPY).

Q100. India hosted the BRICS Women Working Group Meeting in Kochi, Kerala under its BRICS Chairship 2026. BRICS currently comprises how many member countries?

a) 9

b) 10

c) 11

d) 12

✓ **Answer: c) 11**

Explanation: India's BRICS 2026 theme is 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.' BRICS represents about 49.5% of the global population.

◆ ENVIRONMENT

Q101. Sarnath was declared India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site. In which Indian state is Sarnath located?

a) Bihar
b) Uttar Pradesh
c) Madhya Pradesh
d) Jharkhand

✓ Answer: b) Uttar Pradesh

Explanation: It is the place where Lord Buddha delivered his first sermon (Dhammachakra Pravartana) after attaining enlightenment. UNESCO Headquarters: Paris, France.

Q102. A new deep-sea fish, Cyttopsis indica (Indian dory), was discovered in the Arabian Sea off Kerala by which institution?

a) ICAR-CMFRI
b) NCPOR
c) NIO Goa
d) FSI

✓ Answer: a) ICAR-CMFRI

Explanation: CMFRI Headquarters: Kochi, Kerala. The species was found at 350-500 metres depth in the Lakshadweep Sea, confirmed through DNA analysis.

Q103. Researchers discovered a new spreadwing damselfly species, Lestes paloti, in Kerala's Western Ghats. It is the first new Lestes species from India since which year?

a) 1975
b) 1987
c) 1995
d) 2005

✓ Answer: b) 1987

Explanation: Also the first from the Western Ghats since 1929. Named after Muhamed Jafer Palot of the Zoological Survey of India. Western Ghats is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a global biodiversity hotspot.

Q104. Borjuli Wetland in Assam was notified as a Biodiversity Heritage Site for conserving which species of wild rice?

a) Oryza sativa
b) Oryza rufipogon
c) Oryza glaberrima
d) Oryza meridionalis

✓ Answer: b) Oryza rufipogon

Explanation: Oryza rufipogon is the wild ancestor of cultivated rice (Oryza sativa), resistant to pests, diseases, floods, and salinity. Biodiversity Heritage Sites are notified under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.

◆ ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

Q105. CCI approved the ₹16,660 crore all-cash acquisition of Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB) by an Aditya Birla-led consortium. RCB was earlier owned by which company?

a) United Breweries
b) United Spirits Ltd. (USL)
c) Diageo India
d) Pernod Ricard India

✓ **Answer: b) United Spirits Ltd. (USL)**

Explanation: The consortium includes Aditya Birla Group, Times Group, Bolt Ventures, and Blackstone. CCI regulates competition under the Competition Act, 2002.

Q106. Kotak Mahindra Bank acquired Deutsche Bank India's retail banking and wealth management business for ₹281.7 crore. The acquisition includes approximately how much in loan book?

a) ₹15,000 crore
b) ₹22,000 crore
c) ₹29,000 crore
d) ₹35,000 crore

✓ **Answer: c) ₹29,000 crore**

Explanation: The acquisition also includes ₹16,000 crore deposits and ₹10,500 crore AUM. Around 1,000 employees and 16 of Deutsche Bank's 17 branches will become part of Kotak.

Q107. Aviva will acquire the remaining 26% stake in Aviva Life Insurance India from Dabur Invest Corp, making it the first foreign insurer to own 100% of an Indian life insurance company. The FDI limit in the insurance sector was increased to 100% in which year?

a) 2023
b) 2024
c) 2025
d) 2026

✓ **Answer: d) 2026**

Explanation: Aviva Life Insurance India was established in 2001 as a joint venture. Previously, the FDI limit was 74%.

Q108. Fairfax Financial Holdings will acquire a stake in IDBI Bank in a deal valued at $5.5 billion. IDBI Bank is jointly owned by which two entities?

a) RBI and SBI
b) Government of India and LIC
c) GoI and World Bank
d) LIC and SBI

✓ **Answer: b) Government of India and LIC**

Explanation: Fairfax Financial Holdings is a Canada-based investment and insurance company led by Prem Watsa. Fairfax already owns a 40% stake in CSB Bank through its Indian subsidiary.

◆ INDIA & WORLD

Q109. PM Modi became the first Indian PM to address the Parliament of Indonesia. India and Indonesia signed how many MoUs/Agreements during the visit?

a) 8
b) 10
c) 14
d) 18

✓ **Answer: c) 14**

Explanation: Key announcements included Tagore-Dewantara Year (2027), IIM Bangalore campus at Singhasari SEZ, and launch of Indonesia Open Network (ION) based on ONDC. Capital of Indonesia: Jakarta.

Q110. India and Israel's Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA) came into force on which date in 2026?

a) 1 July 2026
b) 4 July 2026
c) 15 July 2026
d) 26 July 2026

✓ Answer: b) 4 July 2026

Explanation: The BIA was originally signed on 8 September 2025 in New Delhi. It aims to promote and protect bilateral investments between India and Israel.

Q111. APEDA facilitated the first export shipment of Areko Cherries and Scentrose Plums from which J&K districts to the UAE?

a) Bandipora and Kupwara
b) Shopian and Pulwama
c) Anantnag and Kulgam
d) Baramulla and Sopore

✓ Answer: b) Shopian and Pulwama

Explanation: APEDA functions under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry. APEDA stands for Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority.

◆ OBITUARY

Q112. Teejan Bai, the legendary Pandavani folk singer who passed away at age 70, received the Padma Vibhushan. Pandavani is a traditional folk art form of which state?

a) Odisha
b) Jharkhand
c) Chhattisgarh
d) Madhya Pradesh

✓ Answer: c) Chhattisgarh

Explanation: Pandavani is based on stories from the Mahabharata. Teejan Bai also received Padma Shri and Padma Bhushan. She was a renowned Pandavani folk singer.

Q113. S. Janaki, known as the 'Nightingale of the South', passed away at 88. Approximately how many songs did she sing in multiple Indian languages?

a) 20,000
b) 35,000
c) 48,000
d) 60,000

✓ Answer: c) 48,000

Explanation: S. Janaki received the Padma Bhushan in 2013. She won the National Film Award for her contribution to Indian music.

Q114. Sir Garfield Sobers, the legendary West Indies cricketer who passed away at 89, scored a record 365 against Pakistan in 1958. How many Tests did he play?

a) 80
b) 93
c) 100
d) 110

✓ Answer: b) 93

Explanation: He scored 8032 runs in 93 Tests. Sobers is regarded as one of cricket's greatest all-rounders.

◆ INSURANCE

Q115. IRDAI granted registration to Prudential HCL Health Insurance as a standalone health insurer. With this, the number of standalone health insurance companies in India increased to how many?

a) 6
b) 7
c) 8
d) 9

✓ Answer: c) 8

Explanation: Prudential HCL Health Insurance is a joint venture between Prudential Group (UK) and HCL Group (India). IRDAI is headquartered in Hyderabad, Telangana.

Q116. IRDAI approved the acquisition of Magma General Insurance by Patanjali Ayurved and DS Group. Patanjali Ayurved will acquire what stake?

a) 51.00%
b) 60.25%
c) 73.56%
d) 80.00%

✓ Answer: c) 73.56%

Explanation: DS Group will acquire 24.50%. The acquisition is valued at ₹4,500 crore. Approval is valid for 3 months from 28 July 2026.

◆ APPS & PORTALS

Q117. EPFO launched the upgraded CITES 2.01 platform, migrating how many member accounts to a single centralised database?

a) 200 million
b) 280 million
c) 320 million
d) 340 million

✓ Answer: d) 340 million

Explanation: The platform offers a unified digital interface, faster claim processing, and automated claim validation. EPF interest for FY 2025-26 will be credited by 15 July 2026. EPFO Headquarters: New Delhi.

Q118. Tamil Nadu launched Nalam TN, an AI-powered WhatsApp chatbot for online OP booking. What is the WhatsApp number to access this service?

a) 9619111999
b) 9619222999
c) 9619333999
d) 9619444999

✓ Answer: b) 9619222999

Explanation: Tamil Nadu CM Vijay launched the chatbot. It is operational on a pilot basis in 22 districts including Chennai and Chengalpattu. It also enables transparent donations and sponsorship of medical equipment.

Q119. SWIFT launched a blockchain-based platform for 24×7 cross-border payments. How many global banks are piloting live transactions?

a) 10
b) 13
c) 17
d) 22

✓ **Answer: c) 17**

Explanation: Banks include HSBC, Citigroup, BNY Mellon, Standard Chartered, and UBS. SWIFT stands for Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication. SWIFT HQ: La Hulpe, Belgium.

◆ STATES & UTs

Q120. Gujarat's Unjha Cumin and Fennel received the GI tag. GI tags are granted under which Act?

a) Trade Marks Act, 1999
b) Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999
c) Patents Act, 1970
d) Designs Act, 2000

✓ **Answer: b) Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999**

Explanation: GI tags are granted by the Geographical Indications Registry, Chennai. India is the world's largest producer and exporter of cumin, with Gujarat being the largest cumin-producing state.

Q121. Delhi will implement the 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' programme with ₹8,300 crore outlay for 2026-2033, supported by the World Bank. Who is the Chief Minister of Delhi?

a) Arvind Kejriwal
b) Manish Sisodia
c) Rekha Gupta
d) Atishi

✓ **Answer: c) Rekha Gupta**

Explanation: The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) is the statutory body for air quality management in the NCR. Lieutenant Governor of Delhi: V. K. Saxena.

Q122. Killai in Cuddalore district became Tamil Nadu's first fully operational Climate Resilient Village (CRV). Which mangrove forest, one of the world's largest, is located near Killai?

a) Bhitarkanika Mangroves
b) Sundarbans
c) Pichavaram Mangrove Forest
d) Coondapur Mangroves

✓ **Answer: c) Pichavaram Mangrove Forest**

Explanation: Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission (TNCCM) implemented this at ₹230.15 lakh. CM of Tamil Nadu: C. Joseph Vijay | Governor: R. N. Ravi.

Q123. Andhra Pradesh signed an MoU with UN-Habitat to establish a Centre of Excellence for Urban Affairs in which city?

a) Visakhapatnam
b) Hyderabad
c) Amaravati
d) Guntur

✓ **Answer: c) Amaravati**

Explanation: UN-Habitat is the United Nations Human Settlements Programme, headquartered in Nairobi, Kenya. The partnership focuses on sustainable urban development, climate resilience, and digital governance.

◆ AGRI-BUSINESS

Q124. The government raised the onion procurement price by 13% to ₹2,125 per quintal. Procurement is being done through NAFED and NCCF. What does NAFED stand for?

a) National Agricultural Finance and Export Development
b) National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd.
c) National Agency for Farm Export Development
d) National Agricultural Federation of Export Dealers

✓ Answer: b) National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd.

Explanation: Onion production for 2025-26 is estimated at 307.37 lakh metric tonnes. The Price Stabilisation Fund (PSF) is used to manage price volatility of essential commodities such as onions and pulses.

Q125. India approved the use of Anhydrous Ammonia (82% Nitrogen) for agricultural purposes, making it the 4th country to use ammonia directly in farming. Which countries were ahead of India?

a) USA, Germany & Canada
b) US, Canada & Australia
c) Japan, China & USA
d) Russia, Ukraine & USA

✓ Answer: b) US, Canada & Australia

Explanation: The approval is valid for 3 years under the Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985. Urea contains 46% Nitrogen while Anhydrous Ammonia contains 82% Nitrogen.

◆ COMMITTEES

Q126. SEBI constituted an Expert Working Group (EWG) to review the regulatory framework for debenture trustees. Who chairs this panel?

a) Ashish Kumar Chauhan
b) Rajnish Kumar
c) Ananta Barua
d) K.V. Kamath

✓ Answer: c) Ananta Barua

Explanation: Ananta Barua is a former SEBI Whole-Time Member. Rajnish Kumar (former SBI Chairman) serves as Co-Chairperson. SEBI was established in 1988 and given statutory status under the SEBI Act, 1992.

◆ MIXED IMPORTANT TOPICS

Q127. India joined the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies. The agreement was adopted at which WTO Ministerial Conference?

a) MC10 in Nairobi
b) MC11 in Buenos Aires
c) MC12 in Geneva
d) MC13 in Abu Dhabi

✓ **Answer: c) MC12 in Geneva**

Explanation: The agreement bans subsidies linked to IUU (Illegal, Unreported, Unregulated) fishing and overfished stocks. It regulates harmful fishing subsidies globally.

Q128. PMKSY completed 10 years in July 2026. Over how many farmers have benefited since 2016-17?

a) 15 million
b) 20 million
c) 27 million
d) 35 million

✓ **Answer: c) 27 million**

Explanation: Central assistance under the scheme exceeded ₹64,407 crore. 110.92 lakh hectares have been brought under micro-irrigation. PMKSY was launched on 1 July 2015.

Q129. India's first High-Altitude Medicine Centre will be set up by ICMR at Keylong in which state?

a) Uttarakhand
b) Sikkim
c) Himachal Pradesh
d) Arunachal Pradesh

✓ **Answer: c) Himachal Pradesh**

Explanation: It will focus on high-altitude and climate-related health research, and support tribal health and disaster preparedness. ICMR is headquartered in New Delhi.

Q130. NCVET recognised NIRD&PR as an Awarding Body (Dual). NIRD&PR is headquartered in which city?

a) Hyderabad
b) New Delhi
c) Bhopal
d) Lucknow

✓ **Answer: a) Hyderabad**

Explanation: NIRD&PR stands for National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj. It can now assess, certify, and award qualifications with focus on rural skills, entrepreneurship, and Panchayati Raj training.

Q131. The government extended the EPF Scheme 2026 which replaced the EPF Scheme, 1952. What year was the EPF (Employees' Provident Fund) Scheme, 1952 established?

a) 1948
b) 1952
c) 1955
d) 1960

✓ **Answer: b) 1952**

Explanation: The EPF Scheme 2026 was notified under the Code on Social Security, 2020. EPFO functions under the Ministry of Labour & Employment.

Q132. ICAR's 98th Foundation Day unveiled the roadmap 'Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan'. ICAR was established on which date?

a) 16 July 1929
b) 1 April 1935
c) 15 August 1950
d) 26 January 1952

✓ **Answer: a) 16 July 1929**

Explanation: ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) is India's apex agricultural research organisation. It functions under the Department of Agricultural Research and Education (DARE), Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare.

Q133. India became the world's 2nd-largest supplier of seafarers according to the BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026, behind which country?

a) China
b) Indonesia
c) Philippines
d) Bangladesh

✓ **Answer: c) Philippines**

Explanation: India contributes 3,11,936 seafarers (12.16%). The government launched Mission 20% to raise India's global seafarer share to 20% by the end of the decade. Ministry: Ports, Shipping & Waterways.

Q134. The 36th NATO Summit 2026 was held in which city?

a) Brussels, Belgium
b) Warsaw, Poland
c) Ankara, Turkey
d) Madrid, Spain

✓ **Answer: c) Ankara, Turkey**

Explanation: Turkey hosted the NATO Summit for the second time. Earlier in 2004 it was held in Istanbul. Secretary General: Mark Rutte. NATO was established on 4th April 1949 and has 32 member nations.

Q135. NeVA Sewa Kendras have been established in how many Legislative Houses under the National e-Vidhan Application project?

a) 15
b) 18
c) 22
d) 28

✓ **Answer: c) 22**

Explanation: NeVA Public Portal is available in 23 languages and provides online access to Bills, Questions, and Proceedings. NeVA stands for National e-Vidhan Application.

Q136. MECON Ltd. was granted Miniratna Category-I status after achieving a net worth of ₹535.42 crore in March 2026. MECON is headquartered in which city?

a) Bokaro
b) Ranchi
c) Jamshedpur
d) Rourkela

✓ **Answer: b) Ranchi**

Explanation: MECON reported profits for the last three consecutive financial years. Miniratna Category-I status provides greater financial and operational autonomy.

Q137. Union Cabinet approved ₹1,27,500 crore for Semicon 2.0. What is the name of the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)?

a) India Chip Mission
b) India Semiconductor Mission
c) Bharat Silicon Mission
d) Digital Chip India

✓ **Answer: b) India Semiconductor Mission**

Explanation: ISM was launched in 2021 under the Digital India Programme. Semicon 2.0 focuses on design, fabs, ATMP/OSAT, R&D, materials, and talent development, building on Semicon 1.0.

Q138. NABARD launched Gramodyam on its 45th Foundation Day to support rural entrepreneurship. NABARD was established on which date?

a) 12 July 1980
b) 12 July 1982
c) 1 April 1982
d) 1 July 1985

✓ **Answer: b) 12 July 1982**

Explanation: Gramodyam is implemented with NSDC under MSDE. The pilot aims to create 4,000 rural entrepreneurs in 3 years. NABARD is headquartered in Mumbai, Maharashtra.

Q139. India's first immersive language museum 'Shabdalok' showcases how many official languages of India?

a) 18
b) 20
c) 22
d) 24

✓ **Answer: c) 22**

Explanation: The museum was developed by the National Library under the Ministry of Culture. 'Shabdalok' means 'Museum of Word'. National Library of India is located in Kolkata, West Bengal.

Q140. India secured joint first position at the 56th IPhO 2026 with 5 gold medals. The Physics Olympiad was held in which city of Colombia?

a) Bogotá
b) Medellín
c) Bucaramanga
d) Cali

✓ **Answer: c) Bucaramanga**

Explanation: 381 students from 87 countries participated. HBCSE is a National Centre of TIFR and coordinates India's Science Olympiad programme.

Q141. PLI schemes attracted investments of over ₹2.40 trillion until March 2026. Which sector received the highest investment?

a) Electronics Manufacturing
b) Mobile Manufacturing
c) High Efficiency Solar PV Modules
d) Pharmaceuticals

✓ **Answer: c) High Efficiency Solar PV Modules**

Explanation: PLI Scheme was launched in 2020 to boost domestic manufacturing. 1.415 million jobs were created till March 2026. Exports worth over ₹15.2 trillion were enabled.

Q142. India's first hydrogen train 'Namo Green Rail' was inaugurated by PM Modi in which state, making India the 5th country to operate hydrogen trains?

a) Rajasthan
b) Uttar Pradesh
c) Haryana
d) Punjab

✓ **Answer: c) Haryana**

Explanation: It operates in the Jind-Sonipat section in Haryana. Germany was the first country to operate hydrogen trains, followed by China, Japan, and USA.

Q143. The 10th India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026 has which theme, to be held from 7-10 October 2026 in New Delhi?

a) 'Digital for All'
b) 'Connected India'
c) 'Scale without Boundaries'
d) 'Tech Enabled India'

✓ **Answer: c) 'Scale without Boundaries'**

Explanation: IMC 2026 is organised by DoT and COAI with four pillars: Srishti, Suraksha, Sashakt & Samvardhan.

Q144. The government approved the BHAVYA-Rasayan Scheme with ₹3,030 crore outlay to establish how many large chemical parks?

a) 2
b) 3
c) 4
d) 5

✓ **Answer: b) 3**

Explanation: Each park will be spread over at least 2,000 acres. The Centre will provide up to ₹1,000 crore per park. Each park is expected to attract ₹20,000-50,000 crore in investments.

Q145. India improved from 82nd to 57th in the Market Distortions Performance Index (2010-2023), released by which organisation?

a) World Bank
b) IMF
c) Competere Foundation
d) WTO

✓ **Answer: c) Competere Foundation**

Explanation: Improvement attributed to reforms such as GST, Insolvency & Bankruptcy Code (IBC) and trade facilitation. The report was launched at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi.

Q146. Charles Leclerc won the F1 British Grand Prix at Silverstone, marking Ferrari's how-many-th Formula One Grand Prix victory?

a) 200th
b) 225th
c) 250th
d) 275th

✓ **Answer: c) 250th**

Explanation: George Russell finished second while Lewis Hamilton came third. It was Leclerc's 9th Formula One race win. Silverstone Circuit hosts the British Grand Prix in England.

Q147. India won 4 gold medals at the 58th International Chemistry Olympiad held in Tashkent. Tashkent is the capital of which country?

a) Kazakhstan
b) Uzbekistan
c) Turkmenistan
d) Tajikistan

✓ **Answer: b) Uzbekistan**

Explanation: India finished joint first with China, Vietnam, and Russia (Individual Participant). HBCSE, under TIFR, conducts India's selection and training for IChO.

Q148. India's first AI-Integrated Vertical University Campus 'VISTAS Thiruvanmiyur Campus' was inaugurated by which Padma Shri awardee?

a) Narayana Murthy
b) Sridhar Vembu
c) Azim Premji
d) Shiv Nadar

✓ **Answer: b) Sridhar Vembu**

Explanation: Sridhar Vembu is the founder of Zoho Corporation, headquartered in Chennai, Tamil Nadu. Industry partnerships include Intel Unnati, TCS iON, Microsoft, and Oracle Academy.

Q149. Powergrid secured an 80 billion yen green loan from JBIC for the Khavda-Nagpur HVDC project. What does JBIC stand for?

a) Japan Business Investment Corporation
b) Japan Bank for International Cooperation
c) Joint Banking and Investment Commission
d) Japan Bureau of Infrastructure Construction

✓ **Answer: b) Japan Bank for International Cooperation**

Explanation: The project will transmit renewable power from Khavda, Gujarat. JBIC provided a green loan to support India's clean energy transmission infrastructure.

Q150. Which Indian state became the first to qualify for the Second RKVY Installment after achieving over 75% utilisation of the first installment?

a) Gujarat
b) Tamil Nadu
c) Maharashtra
d) Andhra Pradesh

✓ **Answer: c) Maharashtra**

Explanation: RKVY stands for Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana. Centre will release ₹335 crore as the second installment. Union Agriculture Minister: Shivraj Singh Chouhan.

Q151. Sourav Ganguly, Kevin Pietersen, and Anjum Chopra were inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame. The total number of Hall of Fame members reached which figure?

a) 115
b) 120
c) 125
d) 130

✓ **Answer: c) 125**

Explanation: The ICC Hall of Fame was launched in 2009. Anjum Chopra became the first Indian woman to score 1,000 ODI runs and play 100 ODIs. Ganguly captained India to the 2002 ICC Champions Trophy title (joint winners).

Q152. PMKSY (Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana) completes 10 years in 2026. How many lakh hectares have been brought under micro-irrigation?

a) 85.67 lakh ha
b) 97.43 lakh ha
c) 110.92 lakh ha
d) 125.50 lakh ha

✓ **Answer: c) 110.92 lakh ha**

Explanation: PMKSY was launched on 1 July 2015. Central assistance exceeded ₹64,407 crore. Over 27 million farmers have benefited since 2016-17.

Q153. India's first PinS (Point-in-Space) Instrument Approach Procedure for helicopters was developed by which authority?

a) DGCA
b) AAI
c) MoCA
d) Indian Air Force

✓ **Answer: b) AAI**

Explanation: It was approved by DGCA using satellite-based navigation technology at Undavalli Heliport. DGCA is the aviation safety regulator under the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

Q154. India's UN SDG Index 2026 rank is 94 out of 169 countries. India's overall score was 68.3. Which country topped the SDG Index 2026?

a) Denmark
b) Sweden
c) Finland
d) Norway

✓ **Answer: c) Finland**

Explanation: Top three countries were Finland, Sweden, and Denmark. India improved from rank 99 in the previous year. Sudan was at the last position (169). Report released by UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

Q155. Vizhinjam International Seaport received Customs nod for Exim operations from which date?

a) 1 August 2026
b) 18 August 2026
c) 15 September 2026
d) 1 October 2026

✓ **Answer: b) 18 August 2026**

Explanation: Approval was granted by CBIC. It was developed under a PPP model by the Kerala Government & Adani Ports. The port handled 2 million TEUs within 18 months. CBIC functions under the Ministry of Finance.

Q156. India ranks 1st in cotton acreage globally. What is India's cotton production estimate for 2025-26?

a) 225.60 lakh bales
b) 256.47 lakh bales
c) 290.91 lakh bales
d) 315.00 lakh bales

✓ **Answer: c) 290.91 lakh bales**

Explanation: India also ranks 2nd in production & consumption globally. Mission for Cotton Productivity targets 498 lakh bales by 2031. Cotton supports 6 million farmers and 40-50 million jobs. Cotton is known as India's 'White Gold'.

Q157. The BRICS Women Ministerial Meeting concluded in Kochi, adopting the first-ever Joint Statement under the BRICS Women Track. India's BRICS 2026 theme is what?

a) 'Together for a Better World'
b) 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'

c) 'BRICS for Global Good'

d) 'Innovation and Inclusion for BRICS'

✓ **Answer: b) 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'**

Explanation: India hosted the BRICS Women Working Group Meeting in Kochi. BRICS currently comprises 11 member countries and represents about 49.5% of the global population.

Q158. INS Malvan, the second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC), was built by which shipyard and commissioned at which location?

a) Mazagon Dock, Mumbai

b) GRSE, Kolkata

c) Cochin Shipyard Limited, Karwar

d) Goa Shipyard Limited, Vasco

✓ **Answer: c) Cochin Shipyard Limited, Karwar**

Explanation: Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) is headquartered in Kochi, Kerala and works under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways. INS Malvan strengthens India's coastal anti-submarine capabilities.

Q159. Jaipur ranked 6th globally and was the only Indian city in the global top 10 of Happy City Index 2026. Which city topped the Happy City Index 2026?

a) Copenhagen

b) Amsterdam

c) Bath (England)

d) Zurich

✓ **Answer: c) Bath (England)**

Explanation: Jaipur is the capital of Rajasthan and is known as the 'Pink City'. The index measures governance, health, environment, mobility, and quality of life.

Q160. ICMR-MINDS won the Gold Award at the National Awards for e-Governance 2026. This project focuses on which health domain?

a) Cancer Screening

b) Maternal Health

c) Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Screening

d) Diabetes Management

✓ **Answer: c) Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Screening**

Explanation: It was awarded under Innovation by Use of AI and New Age Technologies. Being implemented across 7 states through 7 institutions. ICMR functions under the Department of Health Research, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.

Q161. Telangana will host the 8th Khelo India Youth Games 2026. Khelo India was launched in which year to promote grassroots sports?

a) 2015

b) 2017

c) 2018

d) 2020

✓ **Answer: c) 2018**

Explanation: Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya announced the decision. Around 8,000 athletes, officials, and support staff are expected.

Q162. The Delhi CM unveiled the mascot 'Mayur' for the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship. Delhi CM is currently?

a) Arvind Kejriwal

b) Atishi

c) Rekha Gupta

d) Manish Sisodia

✓ **Answer: c) Rekha Gupta**

Explanation: Mayur is inspired by India's national bird, the peacock. The mascot symbolizes unity and sportsmanship.

Q163. India beat England by 270 runs in the historic first women's cricket Test match at Lord's, London. Who took 4 wickets in this match?

a) Deepti Sharma

b) Smriti Mandhana

c) Sneh Rana

d) Shafali Verma

✓ **Answer: c) Sneh Rana**

Explanation: Deepti Sharma claimed 2 wickets. Kranti Gaud and Yastika Bhatia created historic records at Lord's. Lord's Cricket Ground is known as the 'Home of Cricket'.

Q164. India's first Women's T20I Deaf Cricket Series was won against Sri Lanka 5-0. Who was named Player of the Series?

a) P. Rekha

b) Reddy Jyoshna

c) Anitha Kumari

d) Sunita Rani

✓ **Answer: b) Reddy Jyoshna**

Explanation: This was the international debut tour of the Indian Deaf Women's team. The Deaf International Cricket Council (DICC) governs international deaf cricket.

Q165. George Russell of Mercedes won the 2026 Austrian Grand Prix. At which circuit is the Austrian Grand Prix held?

a) Hockenheimring

b) Nürburgring

c) Red Bull Ring, Spielberg

d) Autodromo Nazionale Monza

✓ **Answer: c) Red Bull Ring, Spielberg**

Explanation: It was Russell's 7th Formula 1 career victory. Max Verstappen finished second, Kimi Antonelli third. Russell started the race from pole position.

Q166. MoES celebrated its 20th Foundation Day and launched 13 Centres of Excellence via IMD. What year was the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) established?

a) 2003

b) 2004

c) 2006

d) 2008

✓ **Answer: c) 2006**

Explanation: IMD & ICAR-NIVEDI signed MoU for WAADRU. New launches include IMD NOVA, WINGS App, Sagar Prahari App, SAHAV 2.0, and Ocean Olympiad India 2026. IMD is headquartered in New Delhi.

Q167. The government's Centre for Air Quality Management (CAQM) is the statutory body for air quality in NCR. Delhi's 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' programme is supported by which international body?

a) UNEP
b) ADB
c) World Bank
d) WHO

✓ **Answer: c) World Bank**

Explanation: The programme has a ₹8,300 crore outlay for 2026-2033. Key interventions include phasing out old vehicles, promoting EVs, and improving public transport.

Q168. The 72nd National Film Awards Best Debut Director was won by Randeep Hooda for which film?

a) Jawan
b) Swatantrya Veer Savarkar
c) Pathaan
d) Sam Bahadur

✓ **Answer: b) Swatantrya Veer Savarkar**

Explanation: Article 370 won Best Feature Film. Yami Gautam won Best Actress. Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan shared the Best Actor award. National Film Awards are presented by the Directorate of Film Festivals.

Q169. JAXA successfully completed Japan's first reusable rocket lift-off and landing test in Noshiro, Akita. JAXA was established in which year?

a) 1999
b) 2001
c) 2003
d) 2005

✓ **Answer: c) 2003**

Explanation: JAXA stands for Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency. The prototype rocket reached 10 metres altitude and completed a 40-second flight.

Q170. India's first Hydrogen train 'Namo Green Rail' makes India the 5th country to operate hydrogen trains. Which country pioneered hydrogen train operations?

a) Japan
b) China
c) USA
d) Germany

✓ **Answer: d) Germany**

Explanation: After Germany, China, Japan, and USA also adopted hydrogen trains. India's Namo Green Rail operates in the Jind-Sonipat section in Haryana.

Q171. Ministry of Coal's AAROH report is about which subject?

a) Coal Production Statistics
b) Annual Report on Mine Closure
c) Coal Export Analysis
d) Mine Safety Report

✓ **Answer: b) Annual Report on Mine Closure**

Explanation: 42 coal mines were scientifically closed for the first time since Independence. Ministry signed an India-Germany (GIZ) Implementation Agreement on scientific mine closure.

Q172. SEBI launched Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs). EGRs represent physical gold in dematerialised form. Under which body are they backed?

a) RBI-accredited vaults
b) MOF-approved vaults
c) SEBI-accredited vaults
d) BIS-certified vaults

✓ **Answer: c) SEBI-accredited vaults**

Explanation: EGRs allow seamless conversion between physical and digital gold. They are traded on stock exchanges like other demat securities.

Q173. BPCL acquired a 40% stake in Tiki Tar and Shell India (TTSIPL) for ₹85 crore to strengthen its presence in which market?

a) Aviation Fuel market
b) Value-Added Bitumen (VAB) market
c) Natural Gas distribution
d) Lubricants market

✓ **Answer: b) Value-Added Bitumen (VAB) market**

Explanation: TTSIPL manufactures and markets VG Bitumen, PMB, CRMB, and Emulsions for highways and airport runways. BPCL is a Maharatna CPSE under the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas.

Q174. PM-Vidyalaxmi portal provides collateral-free education loans. Students with family income up to ₹8 lakh get what interest subvention on loans up to ₹10 lakh?

a) 1%
b) 2%
c) 3%
d) 4%

✓ **Answer: c) 3%**

Explanation: PM-Vidyalaxmi was launched in November 2024. Since launch, 1.12 lakh+ loans worth ₹15,634.78 crore have been sanctioned. It is a Central Sector Scheme for top QHEIs.

Q175. ICAR discovered 43 crop varieties on its 98th Foundation Day. What is ICAR's full form?

a) Indian Council for Agricultural Research
b) Indian Council of Agricultural Research
c) International Council for Agricultural Research
d) Indian Commission of Agricultural Research

✓ **Answer: b) Indian Council of Agricultural Research**

Explanation: ICAR was established on 16 July 1929. It functions under DARE, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare. Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan unveiled the roadmap 'Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan'.

Q176. RBI's Financial Inclusion Index is based on three pillars. Which are they?

a) Reach, Adoption, Impact
b) Access, Usage and Quality
c) Availability, Affordability and Awareness
d) Coverage, Depth and Breadth

✓ **Answer: b) Access, Usage and Quality**

Explanation: RBI launched the Financial Inclusion Index in 2021. The FI Index rose to 70 in FY26 from 67 in FY25. Growth was mainly driven by higher usage of financial services.

Q177. India will host the 12th BRICS Labour and Employment Ministers' Meeting in Hyderabad. Who will chair the meeting?

a) Rajnath Singh
b) Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya
c) Dharmendra Pradhan
d) Piyush Goyal

✓ **Answer: b) Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**

Explanation: BRICS members include Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, and Indonesia — 11 member countries in total.

Q178. Dilip Gavit won gold for India at Commonwealth Games 2026 in Men's 100m T47, setting a Commonwealth Games record. T47 is a category for athletes with which condition?

a) Visual impairment
b) Lower limb impairment
c) Upper limb impairment
d) Intellectual impairment

✓ **Answer: c) Upper limb impairment**

Explanation: Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath won Silver. India achieved a historic 1-2 finish. 2026 Commonwealth Games are being held in Glasgow, Scotland.

Q179. India's Q1 FY27 exports rose to USD 232.7 billion. The trade deficit widened to how much?

a) USD 25.4 billion
b) USD 31.2 billion
c) USD 37.4 billion
d) USD 43.8 billion

✓ **Answer: c) USD 37.4 billion**

Explanation: Merchandise exports increased 15.9% to USD 129.3 billion. Imports rose 17.6% to USD 270.2 billion. DGFT functions under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry.

Q180. Viswanathan Anand became Interim President of FIDE. FIDE was established in which year and where?

a) 1920, London
b) 1924, Paris
c) 1930, Madrid
d) 1936, Berlin

✓ **Answer: b) 1924, Paris**

Explanation: FIDE (Fédération Internationale des Échecs/International Chess Federation) HQ: Lausanne, Switzerland. Anand succeeds Arkady Dvorkovich who was placed under EU sanctions.

Q181. Union Cabinet approved the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme. India is currently the world's second-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume. Who is the largest?

a) USA
b) Vietnam
c) China
d) South Korea

✓ **Answer: c) China**

Explanation: The MPMS has a ₹62,500 crore outlay for FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31. It aims to boost mobile manufacturing, exports, and domestic value addition.

Q182. George Russell won the 2026 Austrian Grand Prix. It was his 7th career F1 victory. Which team does he race for?

a) Red Bull Racing
b) Ferrari
c) Mercedes
d) McLaren

✓ **Answer: c) Mercedes**

Explanation: Max Verstappen finished second, Kimi Antonelli third. The Austrian Grand Prix is held at the Red Bull Ring, Spielberg.

Q183. NPCI's Dilip Asbe joined SWIFT's Global Supervisory Board. SWIFT is headquartered in which city?

a) Brussels, Belgium
b) Geneva, Switzerland
c) La Hulpe, Belgium
d) Frankfurt, Germany

✓ **Answer: c) La Hulpe, Belgium**

Explanation: SWIFT stands for Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication. NPCI also operates IMPS, RuPay, and FASTag.

Q184. India's APEDA facilitated the first-ever sea shipment of value-added flavoured Makhana from which state to Canada?

a) Assam
b) Bihar
c) Jharkhand
d) West Bengal

✓ **Answer: b) Bihar**

Explanation: 7 metric tonnes of flavoured Makhana were exported from Darbhanga via Mundra Port. Value addition helped Makhana farmers earn over 50% higher returns. APEDA stands for Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority.

Q185. India signed the WTO Fisheries Subsidies Agreement. What does IUU fishing stand for?

a) Inland, Unsustainable and Unregulated
b) Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated
c) International, Underwater and Unsupervised
d) Inland, Unapproved and Unauthorised

✓ **Answer: b) Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated**

Explanation: The agreement bans subsidies linked to IUU fishing and overfished stocks. Adopted at 12th WTO Ministerial Conference (MC12) in Geneva in 2022.

Q186. INS Udaygiri, Shakti, and Kavaratti arrived at Changi Naval Base in Singapore. Changi Naval Base is a facility of which navy?

a) US Seventh Fleet
b) Republic of Singapore Navy
c) Royal Australian Navy
d) British Royal Navy

✓ **Answer: b) Republic of Singapore Navy**

Explanation: The deployment aims to strengthen India-Singapore maritime cooperation. This was part of the Indian Navy's operational deployment.

Q187. The government approved a Greenfield Shipbuilding Cluster in Porbandar, Gujarat, to be developed by NSHIP-Gujarat. What is the annual capacity?

a) 0.5-0.8 million gross tonnage
b) 0.8-1.0 million gross tonnage
c) 1.2-1.5 million gross tonnage
d) 2.0-2.5 million gross tonnage

✓ Answer: c) 1.2-1.5 million gross tonnage

Explanation: Spread across 2,000 acres. A ₹1,570 crore ship repair facility was also approved at Vadinar. Deendayal Port is located in Kandla, Gujarat.

Q188. India hosted the 9th Session of UNCTAD's Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection in Geneva. UNCTAD stands for what?

a) United Nations Trade and Capital Development
b) United Nations Trade and Development
c) United Nations Treasury and Commercial Development
d) United Nations Trade and Commerce Division

✓ Answer: b) United Nations Trade and Development

Explanation: Nidhi Khare, Secretary, Department of Consumer Affairs, chaired the session on behalf of India. UNCTAD is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Q189. The ICGS Akshay Fast Patrol Vessel was built by which shipyard and commissioned at Goa?

a) Mazagon Dock
b) Cochin Shipyard
c) Goa Shipyard Limited
d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders

✓ Answer: c) Goa Shipyard Limited

Explanation: ICGS Akshay will support coastal security, search & rescue, and maritime law enforcement. Indian Coast Guard (ICG) was established in 1978 under the Coast Guard Act, 1978.

Q190. Union Cabinet approved Semicon 2.0. What does ATMP/OSAT stand for in semiconductor manufacturing?

a) Assembly, Testing, Manufacturing and Packaging / Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test
b) Advanced Technology Manufacturing Process / Open Source Assembly Technology
c) Automated Test Management Platform / Optimised Semiconductor Assembly Test
d) Assembly and Thermal Management Process / Outsourced Silicon Assembly Testing

✓ Answer: a) Assembly, Testing, Manufacturing and Packaging / Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test

Explanation: Semicon 2.0 focuses on design, fabs, ATMP/OSAT, R&D, materials, and talent development. India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) was launched in 2021.

Q191. Which Indian cricketer retired from international cricket in July 2026, having played 85 Tests, 90 ODIs, and 20 T20Is?

a) Cheteshwar Pujara
b) Rohit Sharma
c) Ajinkya Rahane
d) Shikhar Dhawan

✓ Answer: c) Ajinkya Rahane

Explanation: Ajinkya Rahane made his international debut in 2011. His last international match was the 2nd Test vs West Indies (July 2023). He captained India to the 2020-21 Border-Gavaskar Trophy series win in Australia. BCCI is headquartered in Mumbai.

Q192. India became the 4th country to use anhydrous ammonia directly in farming. The approval is under the Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985. What is the nitrogen content in anhydrous ammonia?

a) 46%
b) 60%
c) 72%
d) 82%

✓ Answer: d) 82%

Explanation: Urea contains 46% Nitrogen while Anhydrous Ammonia contains 82% Nitrogen. India aims to reduce dependence on urea imports through this move.

Q193. India's SDG Index 2026 rank is 94, improving from 99 in the previous year. Which city/country was at the bottom of the SDG Index 2026?

a) Afghanistan
b) Sudan
c) Chad
d) Somalia

✓ Answer: b) Sudan

Explanation: Sudan was at the last position (169). Finland topped the 2026 SDG Index, followed by Sweden and Denmark. The SDG Index is released by UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

Q194. Charles Leclerc's victory at the 2026 British Grand Prix was Ferrari's 250th Formula One victory. At which circuit was this race held?

a) Circuit de Catalunya
b) Circuit Gilles-Villeneuve
c) Silverstone Circuit
d) Autodromo Enzo e Dino Ferrari

✓ Answer: c) Silverstone Circuit

Explanation: Silverstone Circuit hosts the British Grand Prix in England. It was Leclerc's 9th F1 race win. George Russell finished second while Lewis Hamilton came third.

Q195. ISRO successfully tested three Gaganyaan crew module systems. Gaganyaan is India's first human spaceflight mission to which orbit?

a) Geostationary Orbit
b) Medium Earth Orbit
c) Low Earth Orbit
d) Highly Elliptical Orbit

✓ Answer: c) Low Earth Orbit

Explanation: Systems tested include uprighting system, umbilical separation, and apex cover separation. Tests ensured astronaut safety during splashdown, re-entry, and parachute deployment.

Q196. DoT signed an MoU with Madhya Pradesh Government to establish a 350-acre Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ) in which city?

a) Bhopal
b) Indore
c) Gwalior
d) Jabalpur

✓ Answer: c) Gwalior

Explanation: Phase-I has ₹493 crore Central funding. Expected investment: ₹12,000-15,000 crore and around 14,000 direct jobs. DoT is under the Ministry of Communications.

Q197. The government launched the first trial Index of Services Production (ISP). What is the base year for ISP?

a) 2022-23
b) 2023-24
c) 2024-25
d) 2025-26

✓ Answer: c) 2024-25

Explanation: The ISP covers 19 service sub-sectors and measures monthly activity in the formal services sector. MoSPI stands for Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.

Q198. Ajinkya Rahane retired from international cricket. He captained India to the 2020-21 Border-Gavaskar Trophy series win in which country?

a) England
b) South Africa
c) Australia
d) New Zealand

✓ Answer: c) Australia

Explanation: Rahane made his debut in 2011 and played 85 Tests, 90 ODIs, and 20 T20Is. His last international match was the 2nd Test vs West Indies (July 2023).

Q199. India hosted the 9th Session of UNCTAD's Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection in Geneva on 6-8 July 2026. Who chaired the session on behalf of India?

a) Apurva Chandra
b) Nidhi Khare
c) Leena Nandan
d) Rohit Kumar Singh

✓ Answer: b) Nidhi Khare

Explanation: Nidhi Khare is the Secretary, Department of Consumer Affairs. UNCTAD (United Nations Trade and Development) is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Q200. India's WTO target for global merchandise exports by 2047 is what percentage, as per WTO report?

a) 5%
b) 7%
c) 10%
d) 15%

✓ Answer: c) 10%

Explanation: India's current share is 1.8% (2024). The goal is aligned with the Viksit Bharat vision. Export growth will be supported through duty exemption, remission, and rebate schemes.

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